

Satchel

User Handbook

Version 0.1 (alpha) — June 2026

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Copyright and disclaimer

Satchel — User Handbook Version 0.1 (alpha) — June 2026

Satchel is open-source software. This handbook is distributed alongside the software and may be reproduced and shared under the same terms. See the LICENSE file in the project repository for details.

Disclaimer — Satchel is software for self-custody trading of digital assets by means of atomic swaps. The project does not operate an exchange, does not take custody of funds, does not match or execute orders on your behalf, and provides no investment advice or guarantees of any kind. You alone hold your keys and your recovery phrase, and you alone are responsible for the security of your funds and the machine on which the software runs. Satchel is **alpha** software under active development and external audit; the information in this handbook is provided in good faith and may contain errors or omissions. Consult the official project repository for the most up-to-date information.

Part I

Getting Started

Chapter 1

About this Handbook

Welcome. This is the **Satchel User Handbook** — a friendly, step-by-step guide to trading cryptocurrency directly with another person, with no exchange in the middle and no one ever holding your coins but you.

If that sounds technical, don't worry. This handbook assumes **no background in cryptocurrency**. Wherever a new idea comes up — a *swap*, a *seed*, a *recovery phrase* — we explain it the first time you meet it, in plain language, before moving on. You will need to be comfortable installing a desktop application and following on-screen steps; everything beyond that, we walk you through.

1.1 Who this is for

This handbook is for **anyone who wants to trade one cryptocurrency for another without trusting a middleman**. You might be:

- Someone curious about *trustless trading* — swapping coins peer-to-peer in a way where the blockchain itself enforces the deal, so neither side can run off with the other's money.
- Someone who already holds Bitcoin or Bitcoin-PoCX and wants to trade between them safely, on your own machine, on your own terms.
- A member of a community that runs its own trading noticeboard and wants to use it.

You do **not** need to know how Bitcoin works under the hood, what a "transaction" is, or any programming. If you ever do want the deep technical detail — how the swap transactions are built, the exact protocol — that lives in a separate companion book, the *Pact Developer & Integrator Handbook*. This handbook points you there only when it is genuinely useful.

1.2 How this handbook is organised

The handbook is in four parts, moving from "getting set up" to "trading" to "the finer points":

1. **Getting Started** — what Satchel is, installing it, creating your trading identity, and connecting your coins. Start here. (*You are reading this part.*)

2. **Trading** — a tour of the app, browsing the **Corkboard**, posting an offer, taking someone else's, watching a swap complete, your wallet view, and private one-to-one offers.
3. **Transports & Network** — how your offers reach other people (over **Nostr** or a **Corkboard**), and the settings that control it.
4. **Safety & Reference** — keeping your funds safe, what really happens during a swap, troubleshooting, a glossary of terms, and where to get help.

You do not have to read straight through. If you just want to get trading, work through Part 1 once, then dip into Part 2 as you go.

1.3 Conventions used in this book

We use a few simple conventions throughout.

- **Callouts** flag things worth pausing on:

Tip — a shortcut or a friendlier way to do something.

Note — background, a clarification, or a pointer to another chapter.

Warning — something that could cost you funds if you get it wrong. Please read these carefully.

- **Text styles** carry meaning. **Bold** marks something you see on screen — a button, a field, a menu, or the name of a screen. Monospace marks anything you type exactly, a file path, or a web address. *Italics* introduce a new term the first time it appears.
- **Numbered steps** are procedures to follow in order. Bulleted lists are just lists.
- **Screenshots** show you what a screen looks like. Satchel is young and changing quickly, so a screenshot may differ slightly from what you see — the labels and the order of steps are what matter, and we keep those accurate.
- **Cross-references** name another chapter by its title — for example, *see the chapter "Setting Up Your Coins"* — rather than by number, because numbers shift as the book grows.

1.4 Versions covered

This edition covers **Satchel 0.1 (alpha)**, as of **June 2026**.

Note — Satchel is *alpha* software: an early release, still under active development and external security review. The first trading pair is **BTCX ↔ BTC** (BTCX is Bitcoin-PoCX). Screens, labels, and details can change between releases; where an exact detail matters, the app itself is the final word.

1.5 A word on safety

Trustless trading puts you in full control — which also means **you alone are responsible for your funds**. This is different from an exchange, where a company holds your coins (and can lose or freeze them). With Satchel, no one can freeze or seize your funds. The flip side is that no one can recover them for you either. Two rules carry almost all the safety you need:

Warning — When you create your trading identity, Satchel shows you a *recovery phrase* — a list of 12 or 24 words. **Write it down on paper and keep it somewhere safe.** It is the only way to recover your funds if your computer is lost or breaks.

Warning — **Never share your recovery phrase with anyone, and never type it into a website.** Anyone who has those words can take your funds. No genuine support person will ever ask for it. Satchel will never ask you to enter it on a web page.

We come back to safety in detail in the chapter “*Staying Safe*”, but those two rules are worth carrying with you from page one.

1.6 Where to get help

- The project’s repository and website carry release notes, design notes, and the latest news.
- The chapter “*Troubleshooting*” covers the most common snags — a node that won’t connect, an offer that won’t post — with fixes.
- The chapter “*Getting Help*” lists the community channels where you can ask questions.
- If you want the technical “how it works” underneath Satchel, the companion *Pact Developer & Integrator Handbook* is the place to look.

Chapter 2

What Satchel Is

Satchel is a desktop app for **trading one cryptocurrency for another, directly with another person**. There is no company in the middle. No one takes custody of your coins, no one matches your trades, and there are no trading fees. You and your counterparty swap directly, and the blockchain itself makes sure neither of you can cheat.

This chapter explains, in plain language, what that means and how the pieces fit together. You don't need any of it to start trading — but it helps to know what is actually happening to your money.

2.1 Trading without a middleman

On a normal exchange, you hand your coins to the exchange, it holds them, and it arranges trades on your behalf. You are trusting that company not to lose your funds, not to freeze your account, and not to disappear. Plenty have.

Satchel works differently. It uses an *atomic swap* — a way of trading two coins so that the exchange happens **all at once or not at all**. Either both sides get what they agreed to, or both sides keep what they started with. There is no in-between where one person has paid and the other has run off. The word *atomic* just means “indivisible”: the trade cannot be left half-finished.

Because the blockchain enforces this, you never have to trust the other person — and you never have to trust Satchel with your coins either. This is what we mean by *trustless*: not “no one is trustworthy”, but “you don't need to trust anyone for your money to be safe”.

What this gives you:

- **No custody.** Your coins stay under your control the entire time. Satchel never holds them.
- **No exchange, no account.** There is nothing to sign up for and no company that can freeze you out.
- **No fees.** Satchel takes nothing. You pay only the ordinary network fee that every blockchain charges to process a transaction — the same fee you'd pay sending coins to a friend.

- **No matching engine.** Nobody decides who trades with whom. You browse offers and pick the one you like.

2.2 The village market

Satchel borrows its names from an old-fashioned village market square, because the picture is a good one.

- A *pact* is the **deal** — the agreement to swap so much of one coin for so much of another. (Behind the scenes, “Pact” is also the name of the engine that carries out the deal; more on that below.)
- The *corkboard* is the **noticeboard** in the square where people pin up their offers for everyone to see. You browse it, and when you see a deal you like, you take it.
- Your *satchel* is your **bag** — where your trades settle and where you keep track of what you’ve done.

So in one sentence: a *pact* is posted on the *corkboard*, and settled into your *satchel*. You will see all three words in the app, and now you know what each one means.

2.3 The three moving parts

Under the hood, Satchel has three pieces. The important thing to understand is a single hard rule: **your coins and your keys never leave your own machine.**



Figure 2.1: How the parts fit together: everything that touches your coins runs on your machine; the hosted side only carries signed notes.

On your machine (and only here):

1. **Satchel** — the app you look at. It shows you offers, balances, and the progress of your swaps. It is the friendly face; it does not hold your keys.
2. **The engine** — the part that does the real work of a swap. It holds your keys, builds and watches the swap transactions, and — importantly — automatically gives you your money back if the other side walks away. (Its proper name is *Pact*; the app simply calls it “the engine”.)
3. **Your coin nodes** — your own copies of the Bitcoin-PoCX and Bitcoin networks. Satchel is a *node-backed* app, which means it trades using wallets that live on nodes you run. We cover setting these up in the chapter “*Installing Satchel*” and connecting them in “*Setting Up Your Coins*”.

Hosted elsewhere (and trusted with almost nothing):

4. A **transport** — either a **Nostr** relay or a **Corkboard** — that simply carries your offers and a few sealed coordination messages between you and your counterparty. That’s all it does. It never touches your coins, never matches trades, never charges anything, and cannot read your private messages. It is a noticeboard and a postbox, nothing more.

Note — This wall is the whole point. Everything that could touch your money runs on your computer. The hosted side sees only signed offers and sealed envelopes — never your coins, never your keys. We come back to it in the chapter “*Transports*”.

2.4 What you can trade today

The first supported pair is **BTCX** ↔ **BTC** — that is, Bitcoin-PoCX traded against Bitcoin. *BTCX* is the ticker for Bitcoin-PoCX. More coins will follow, and the app is built so new coins can be added without a new release.

2.5 Setting expectations

Satchel is **alpha** software — an early release. The underlying swap protocols (both the original style and the newer, more private Taproot style) are under external security review. The design is careful and the safety guarantees are real, but this is new software handling real value.

Warning — Because Satchel is alpha and under audit, treat it accordingly: start small, keep amounts modest while you learn, and never put in more than you are comfortable risking on early software. Above all, follow the safety rules in the chapter “*Staying Safe*” — write down your recovery phrase, and never share it.

Chapter 3

Installing Satchel

Installing Satchel is a two-part job. The app itself is a single download. But because Satchel trades using **your own coin nodes**, you also need those nodes running before you can trade. This chapter walks through both, gently.

3.1 What you need first: your own coin nodes

Satchel is a *node-backed* app. A *node* is your own personal copy of a cryptocurrency's network — the software that holds a wallet, knows the current state of the blockchain, and can send and receive coins. When you swap, Satchel uses the wallets on your nodes to fund your side of the trade and to receive the proceeds.

To trade the first pair, you need **two** nodes running on your machine (or on a machine Satchel can reach):

- **Bitcoin-PoCX** (BTCX) — a bitcoin-pocx node.
- **Bitcoin** (BTC) — a standard Bitcoin Core node, or anything compatible with it.

Each node must have its **RPC interface reachable**. *RPC* (Remote Procedure Call) is simply the doorway through which other programs — like Satchel's engine — talk to your node. In practice this means the node is running and configured to accept local connections. You will point Satchel at each node's address and port later, in the chapter "*Setting Up Your Coins*"; for now, the goal is just to have both nodes installed and running.

Note — Don't worry about the exact RPC settings yet. The chapter "*Setting Up Your Coins*" covers the connection form field by field, including how Satchel reads your node's login automatically from its *cookie file* so you usually don't have to type a password.

Tip — You need at least **two** live coins before Satchel will let you trade, because a swap involves two chains. If you only have one node up, that's fine for installing — you'll just finish connecting the second before your first trade.

3.2 Getting the app

Satchel is distributed as a ready-to-run *bundle* — a single download containing everything the app needs.

1. Go to the project's **releases** page.
2. Download the bundle for your operating system:
 - **Windows** — the Windows bundle.
 - **Linux** — the Linux bundle.
3. Unpack it if needed, and run the **Satchel** application.

That's the whole installation. There is nothing to register and no account to create.

Note — macOS is not supported yet. A macOS build is planned but out of scope for this alpha. For now, use Windows or Linux.

3.2.1 What's inside the bundle

The bundle contains two things working together:

- **Satchel** — the app you interact with.
- **The bundled engine** — Satchel ships *Pact*, the swap engine, alongside itself and starts it for you automatically. You don't install or run it separately; Satchel launches it, supervises it, and shuts it down when you're done.

So a single download gives you both the face and the engine. The only thing you provide is your coin nodes.

3.3 Windows: the SmartScreen prompt

Satchel's alpha builds are **not yet code-signed** — signing is a paperwork step the project will complete closer to a stable release. Because of this, Windows **SmartScreen** may show a blue warning the first time you run the app, saying something like *"Windows protected your PC"*.

This is expected for unsigned software and does not mean anything is wrong. To run it:

1. Click **More info** in the SmartScreen dialog.
2. Click **Run anyway**.

Satchel will then start normally.

Warning — Only do this for a bundle you downloaded from the **official** releases page. Treat any copy of "Satchel" from somewhere else with suspicion — a tampered build could put your funds at risk. When in doubt, download fresh from the official source.

3.4 First-time prerequisites

On a current, up-to-date copy of **Windows**, you generally need nothing extra: Satchel uses a component called **WebView2** to draw its window, and WebView2 already ships with modern Windows. If for some reason it is missing, Windows will offer to install it.

On **Linux**, the bundle is self-contained; follow any notes on the releases page for your distribution.

Beyond that, the only real prerequisite is the one from the top of this chapter: **your two coin nodes, up and reachable**.

3.5 For developers: building from source

If you'd rather build Satchel yourself from the source code, that path is for developers and is documented elsewhere:

- The project **README** covers the prerequisites (Rust, Node, the Tauri CLI) and the build commands.
- The companion *Pact Developer & Integrator Handbook* covers the engine in depth.

Most people don't need this — the prebuilt bundle above is all it takes to start trading. With Satchel installed, the next chapter walks you through your very first launch.

Chapter 4

First Launch & Setup

The first time you open Satchel, it walks you through a short setup, one screen at a time, like a friendly wizard. You can't skip ahead and you can't get it wrong by accident — each step unlocks the next. This chapter follows that sequence in order:

1. Create (or import) a **merchant** — your trading identity.
2. Back up your **recovery phrase**, then choose whether to protect it with a passphrase.
3. (On later launches only) **unlock** if you chose a passphrase.

After that, Satchel checks your coins are connected and hands off to the next chapter.

4.1 Step 1 — Create your merchant

The first screen welcomes you and explains that Satchel trades under a *merchant*. A merchant is simply **your trading identity**. Behind that one word sits a tidy rule:

Note — One merchant = one seed = one data folder. A *seed* is the master secret that all your keys come from (more on it in the next step). Each merchant has its own seed, its own swap history, and its own folder on disk — much like separate wallets. Keeping trades under different merchants keeps them from being linked together, which is good for privacy.

You have two choices on this screen:

- **Create new** — make a brand-new identity with a fresh seed. Choose this if you're starting out.
- **Import** — restore an identity you already have, using its recovery phrase. Choose this if you've used Satchel before and want to bring an existing merchant onto this machine.

Let's create a new one.

1. Click **Create new**.
2. Satchel asks for a **Merchant name** — just a friendly label so you can tell your merchants apart (for example, Main). It's only for your own eyes.
3. Click to continue. Satchel creates the merchant and moves you straight to the seed step.

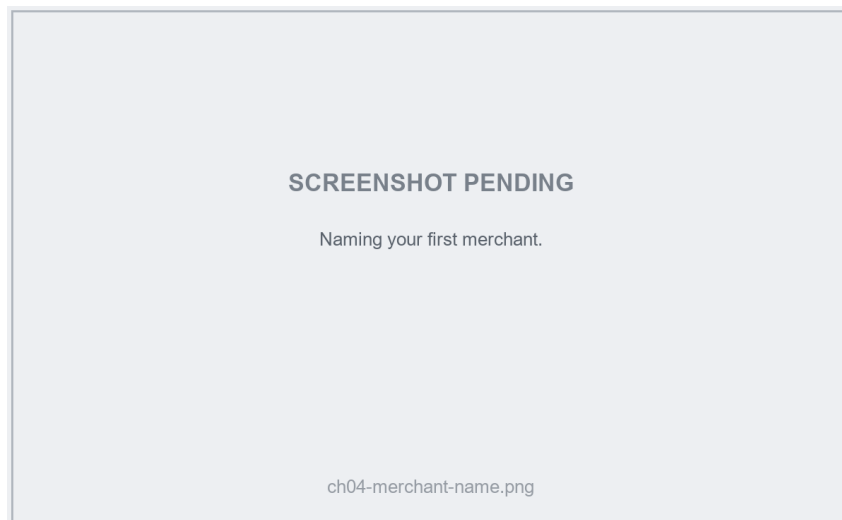


Figure 4.1: Naming your first merchant.

4.2 Step 2 — Your recovery phrase

This is the single most important step in the whole book, so we'll take it slowly.

4.2.1 What a recovery phrase is

When Satchel creates your merchant, it generates a *recovery phrase* (also called a *seed phrase* or *mnemonic*) — a list of **12 or 24 ordinary words**, like ripple cabin lunar quote Those words are a human-readable backup of your seed, the master secret behind every key your merchant uses.

Warning — Anyone who has these words **controls this merchant's funds**. Satchel keeps no copy you can recover from — if you lose the words and lose your computer, the funds are gone for good. This is the trade-off for being your own bank.

4.2.2 Write it down

Satchel shows you the words on a **“Write down your recovery phrase”** screen, numbered in order.

1. Get a pen and paper. (Paper, not a photo and not a text file — a backup that lives only on a device can be lost or stolen along with it.)
2. Write the words down **in order**, with their numbers.
3. Double-check what you wrote against the screen.
4. Tick the box **“I have written down my recovery phrase.”**
5. Continue.

Warning — **Never share these words with anyone, and never type them into a website.** No genuine support person will ever ask for them. Satchel itself will never ask you to re-enter your phrase on a web page.

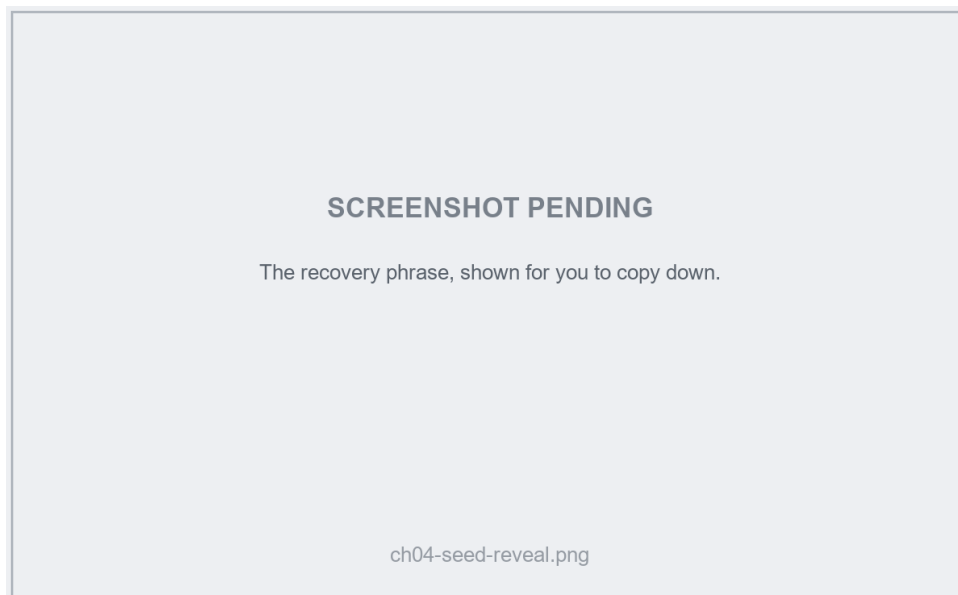


Figure 4.2: The recovery phrase, shown for you to copy down.

4.2.3 Confirm you wrote it down

To make sure your backup is good, Satchel next asks you to **confirm a few words** — it names a couple of positions (for example, “Word #4”) and you type the matching words back. As you type, it offers the valid words so a typo can’t slip through.

If a word doesn’t match, Satchel tells you so you can check your written copy before going on. This little check has saved many people from a backup with a wrong word in it.

Note — On a practice (regtest) network, this confirmation step is skipped, because there’s no real money at stake. On the real network you’ll always be asked to confirm.

4.2.4 Importing instead

If you chose **Import** back in Step 1, this step looks a little different: rather than revealing words, Satchel gives you a box to **enter your existing 12- or 24-word phrase**. It recognises valid words as you type and flags anything that isn’t a real phrase word, and you can paste the whole phrase at once. Then you continue to the passphrase choice, the same as everyone else.

4.3 Step 3 — Passphrase: protect the seed, or not

Last, Satchel asks how to store your seed on disk. Two cards:

- **No passphrase (recommended)** — the seed is stored as-is. You never have to type anything to start trading, and Satchel’s automatic safety net (the part that gives you your money back if a swap stalls) keeps working even after a reboot, with nothing for you to do.
- **Encrypt with a passphrase** — the seed is locked with a passphrase you choose. It’s safer

if someone gets access to your computer's files, but there's a cost: you must re-enter the passphrase each time you start Satchel, and the automatic safety net stays paused until you do.

Note — Satchel **never stores your passphrase**. If you encrypt and then forget the passphrase, no one can unlock the seed for you — your recovery phrase is the only way back in. Either way, your written recovery phrase remains your real backup.

Tip — The seed in a merchant is a *hot* seed — it holds only the temporary keys needed to move coins through a swap, not a long-term vault. For most people, **No passphrase** is the right, convenient choice. Whichever you pick, sweep any sizeable proceeds out to your own main wallet rather than letting them pile up here.

Make your choice and finish. Your merchant is ready.

4.4 Later launches: unlocking

If you chose **No passphrase**, Satchel goes straight to trading every time you open it.

If you chose **Encrypt with a passphrase**, the next time you start Satchel you'll see an **Unlock merchant** screen. Type your passphrase to unlock the seed for this session. Satchel holds it in memory only and forgets it when you close the app — it is never written down. From this screen you can also switch to a different merchant instead.

4.5 Managing more than one merchant

You're not limited to one identity. Later, from the merchant control at the top of the window, you can **create or import more merchants** and **switch** between them — each with its own seed, history, and folder. This is handy for keeping, say, a main identity and a separate one for private trades. We cover the **Merchant Manager** in Part 2.

Note — Satchel won't let you switch away from a merchant that has a swap in progress — that's a safety measure, so an in-flight trade is never abandoned.

4.6 What's next

With your merchant created and your seed backed up, Satchel checks that your coin nodes are connected. If fewer than two coins are live, it opens the coin setup wizard — which is exactly where the next chapter, *"Setting Up Your Coins"*, picks up.

Chapter 5

Setting Up Your Coins

A swap always involves **two** blockchains — you give one coin and receive another. So before Satchel will let you trade, it needs **at least two coins connected and live**. This chapter walks you through connecting them.

If this is your first launch, Satchel brings you here automatically with a “**Connect your coins**” wizard. You can also reach the same setup any time from **Settings** → **Coins**.

Note — *Live* means a coin is connected **and** its node is up and answering. The wizard shows a running count — “1 of 2 coins connected” — and the **Continue** button stays disabled until two coins are live. That’s the safety gate: no trading until you genuinely have two working chains.

5.1 The coins screen

Whether from the first-run wizard or **Settings** → **Coins**, you’ll see a card for each coin Satchel knows about. The first pair is **BTCX** (Bitcoin-PoCX) and **BTC** (Bitcoin). Each card shows:

- The coin’s **icon, name, and symbol**.
- A **status pill** — *Not set up*, *Connected* (with the node’s current block height, called the *tip*), or *Connection error*.
- **Capability chips** — small tags showing what the coin can do (more on these below).
- A **Set up** button (or **Edit connection** if it’s already configured), and a way to remove it.

To connect a coin, click **Set up** on its card.

5.2 The connection form

Setting up a coin means telling Satchel **where your node is** and **how to log in to it**. This is the form that does it. It’s filled in with sensible defaults, so often you’ll only change a field or two.

The fields, in order:

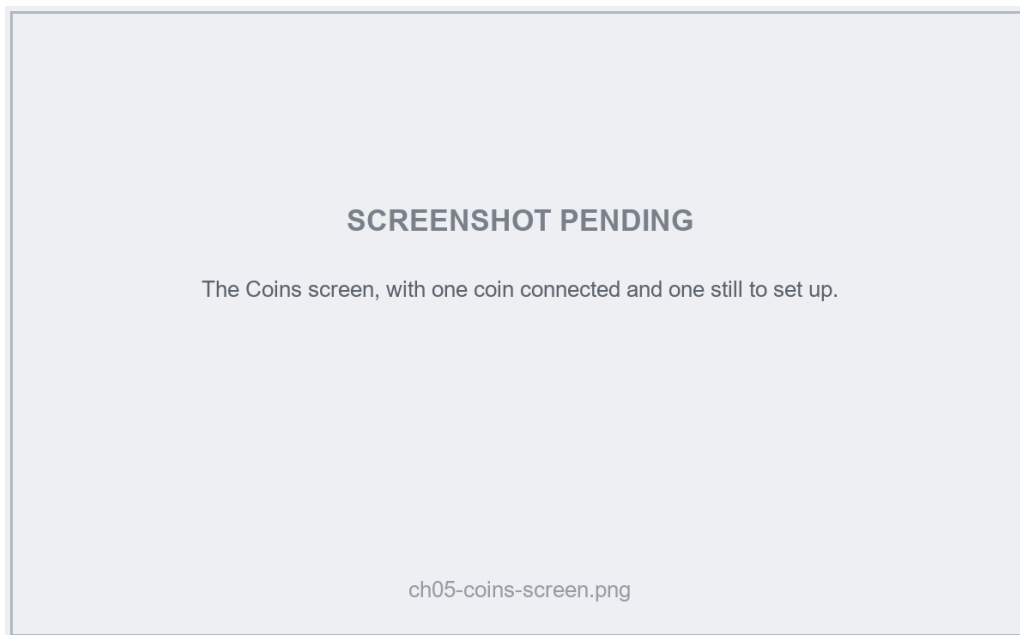


Figure 5.1: The Coins screen, with one coin connected and one still to set up.

- **RPC host** — the address of the machine running the node. The default is `127.0.0.1`, which means “this same computer”. If your node runs on another machine, put its address here.
- **RPC port** — the port number the node listens on for RPC. Each coin and network has its own usual port; the form is pre-filled with the expected one, but check it matches your node’s configuration.
- **Authentication** — how Satchel proves to your node that it’s allowed to connect. Pick one of two cards:
 - **Cookie file** (*the default*) — your node writes a small `.cookie` file containing a one-time login, and Satchel reads it automatically. Nothing to type, nothing to store. When you choose this, a **Node data directory** field appears — point it at your node’s data folder, and Satchel finds the cookie inside (it shows you the exact path it will read).
 - **User / password** — if your node is set up with a fixed `rpcuser` and `rpcpassword` (common for a node on another machine), choose this and enter the **RPC username** and **RPC password** from your node’s config.
- **Wallet name** (*optional*) — if your node has more than one wallet loaded, name the one Satchel should use for this coin. Leave it blank to use the default.
- **Confirmations before final** (*optional*) — how many blocks deep a payment on this chain must be before Satchel treats it as settled. Leave it blank to use the recommended default for the coin. Higher numbers are a little safer against rare blockchain reshuffles, but make swaps slower.

Tip — On the same machine, the **Cookie file** option is the easiest and most secure

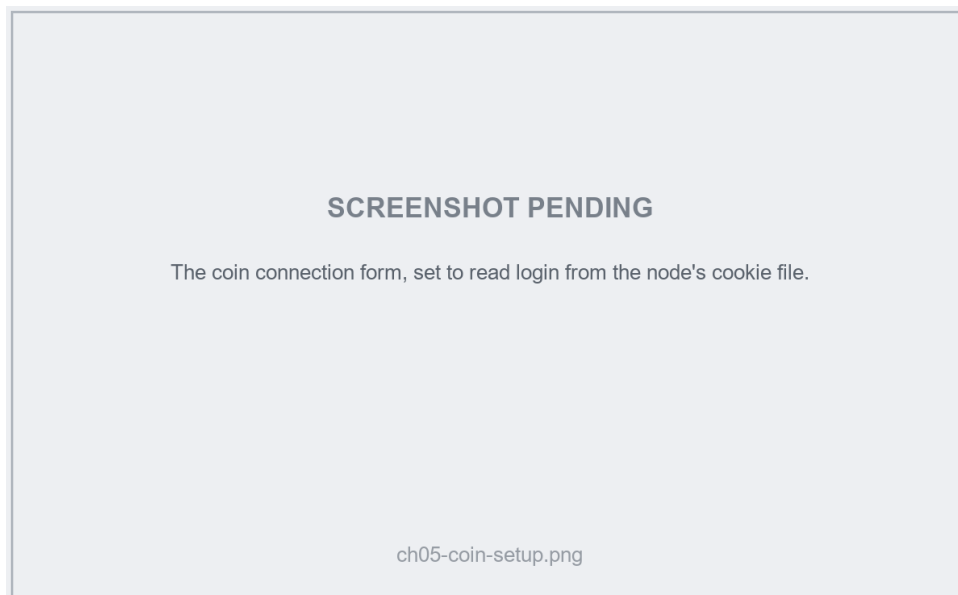


Figure 5.2: The coin connection form, set to read login from the node's cookie file.

choice: there's no password to type or store, and the login rotates automatically. Reach for **User / password** mainly when connecting to a node elsewhere.

5.3 Validate before you save

Here is the part that keeps you safe from a costly mistake: **Satchel checks it's talking to the right blockchain before it saves anything.**

1. With the form filled in, click **Validate node**.
2. Satchel connects to the node and reads its *genesis block* — the unique first block that identifies a chain. It compares that to the genesis it expects for this coin and network.
3. You'll see one of:
 - **Checking the node...** while it works.
 - **Genesis matched — this is the right chain**, along with the node's current **tip height** and the genesis hash. Success.
 - **Rejected — not saving**, if the genesis doesn't match — meaning the node is on the wrong network (or it's the wrong coin entirely).
4. The **Save** button only becomes available **after** validation passes. If you change any field afterward, you'll need to validate again.

Warning — This genesis check exists so your funds can **never** be sent into the wrong chain by a mis-typed port or a node running on the wrong network. Nothing is saved until the check passes — so if validation is rejected, **don't try to force it**. Fix the connection details (usually the port or the data directory) and validate again.

Click **Save**, and Satchel records the connection and reconnects the engine to that node. Repeat for your second coin.

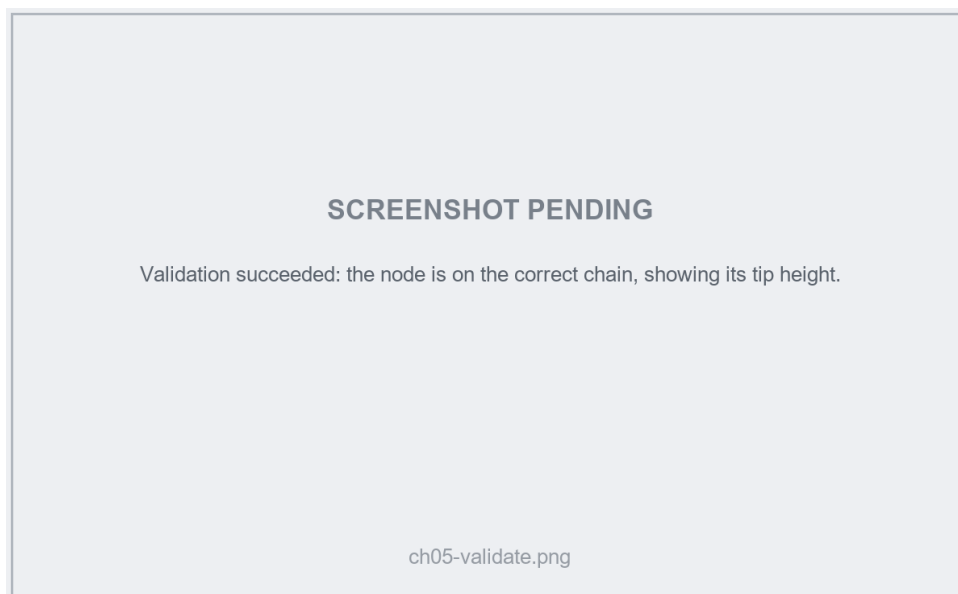


Figure 5.3: Validation succeeded: the node is on the correct chain, showing its tip height.

5.4 Capabilities and trading pairs

Two more things appear on the Coins screen once a coin is connected.

Capability chips — small tags like **CLTV**, **SegWit**, and **Taproot** — describe technical features the coin supports. You don't need to understand them to trade; they simply tell Satchel which kinds of swap it can build with that coin. (If you're curious: *CLTV* enables the time-based safety refund, *SegWit* and *Taproot* are transaction formats — Taproot powers the newer, more private swap style.)

Trading pairs — below the coin cards, Satchel lists the pairs you can trade, derived automatically from what your connected coins can do. There's no fixed list. Each pair shows a readiness label:

- **Ready to trade** — both coins are connected and live. You're good to go.
- **Connect (*coin*)** — you still need to set up one of the two coins.
- **Not buildable yet** — the coins can't form a swap together (for example, one lacks a needed capability).

When **BTCX ↔ BTC** reads **Ready to trade**, you're set.

5.5 Your credentials stay local

A reasonable worry: you've just typed in node details, maybe a password. Where does that go?

Note — Your node credentials are **read and used locally, by the engine on your own machine — never shown back inside the app's window and never sent anywhere**. When you use a cookie file, Satchel reads it directly on your computer; the secret never even reaches the part of the app that draws the screen. Connections are shared across all your merchants, so you set each coin up once.

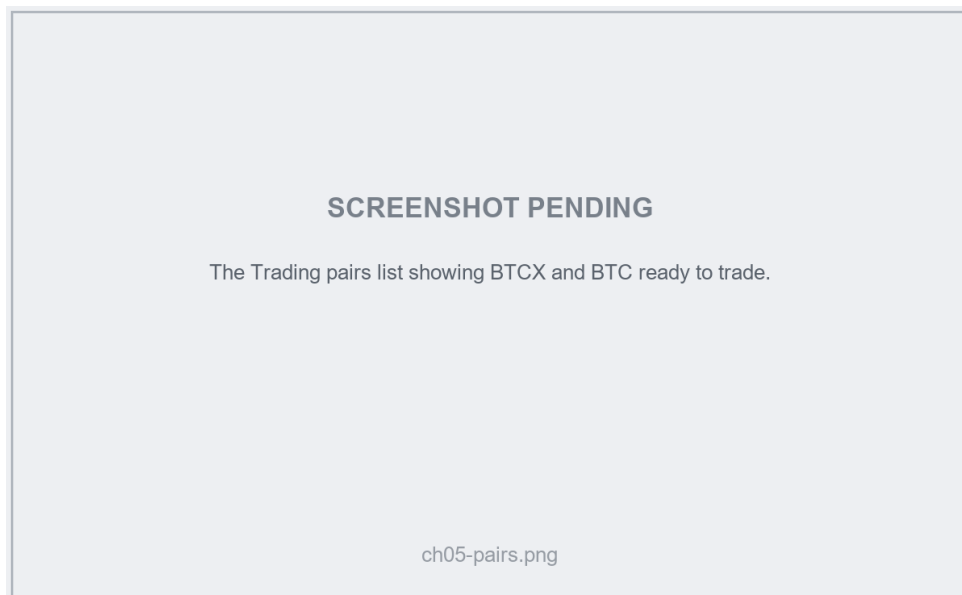


Figure 5.4: The Trading pairs list showing BTCX and BTC ready to trade.

With two coins live and your pair reading **Ready to trade**, the first-run wizard's **Continue** button lights up. Click it, and you arrive at the **Corkboard**, ready for your first trade — which is exactly where Part 2 begins.

Part II

Trading

Chapter 6

A Tour of the Interface

Now that Satchel is set up, let's walk through the screen so you know where everything lives. Nothing here changes your funds — this is just an orientation tour. Open the app and follow along.

Satchel's window is split into three regions: a **left navigation rail** down the side, a thin **header** across the top, and the **main content area** that fills the rest. The chapters that follow each dig into one screen; this one shows you the map.

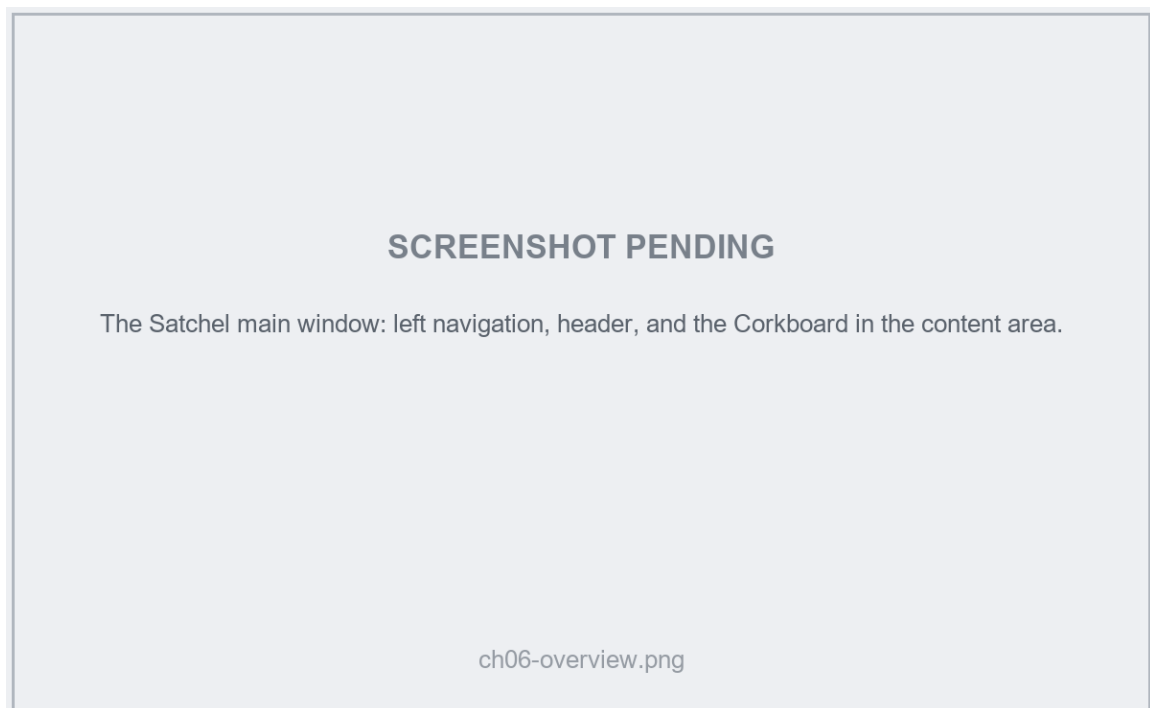


Figure 6.1: The Satchel main window: left navigation, header, and the Corkboard in the content area.

6.1 The left navigation

The rail on the left is how you move between screens. You can collapse it to a slim strip with the menu toggle in the header (handy on a small window), and on a narrow window it slides out as an overlay. At the very top sits the **Satchel** logo with the version number underneath; if a newer release is available, a small update badge appears there — click it to see what's new.

The navigation items are grouped so related tasks sit together:

Public — trading out in the open, where anyone can see and take your offers:

- **Corkboard** — the order book. Browse every offer you can trade and take one. This is where the app opens.
- **Post an offer** — advertise a trade for anyone to take.

Private — trading with one specific person instead of the whole board:

- **Create slip** — build a private offer and get a shareable code (a *slip*).
- **Take a slip** — paste a slip a friend sent you.
- **My slips** — track and cancel the private offers you've handed out.

Below the groups:

- **Swaps** — your full trade history and the swaps currently running.
- **Wallets** — read-only balances from your own coin nodes.

And at the foot of the rail:

- **Settings** — appearance, language, your coin connections, and the noticeboards Satchel talks to.

Tip — If you ever feel lost, click **Corkboard**. It's the home base and it's where your live swaps and activity log are docked (more on that below).

6.2 The active merchant, and switching between merchants

A *merchant* is one trading identity — its own recovery seed, its own swap history, kept separate from any other identity you create. Think of it like a single wallet profile. You set up your first merchant during onboarding.

Just under the logo you'll see a clickable **active-merchant block**: a little identicon, the merchant's name, and a shortened id. This always tells you which identity you're trading as. There's also a matching merchant chip on the right of the header.

To switch, click either one. The merchant chip opens a dropdown with **Manage Merchants...** and a list of your other merchants. Choosing **Manage Merchants...** opens the full manager, where you can create a new merchant, import one from a recovery phrase, or load a different one.

Note — Satchel won't let you switch away from a merchant that has a swap in flight. That's a safety rule: a running swap needs its own seed available to finish or refund. Wait for it to complete, then switch.

6.3 The header status indicators

The left of the header carries a row of small status lights. At a glance they tell you whether Satchel can do its job. Hover any of them for a plain-language tooltip.

- **Engine reachable** — a hub icon that is green when Satchel can talk to the engine (the core that holds your keys and runs swaps) and red when it can't. If this is red, nothing else will work until it recovers.
- **Nostr relay health** — a dot that only appears when you have relays configured. Green means at least one relay is connected; amber means none are reachable right now. (Relays are one way your offers travel — see *Settings* in the relevant chapter.)
- **Per-coin health** — a small glyph for each coin you've connected, bordered by its status. The tooltip tells you whether that coin's node is connected (and its current block height), not set up, or in error.
- **Live-swaps counter** — a gently pulsing swaps icon with a number badge showing how many swaps are running right now. Click it to jump straight to the Corkboard where you can act on them.

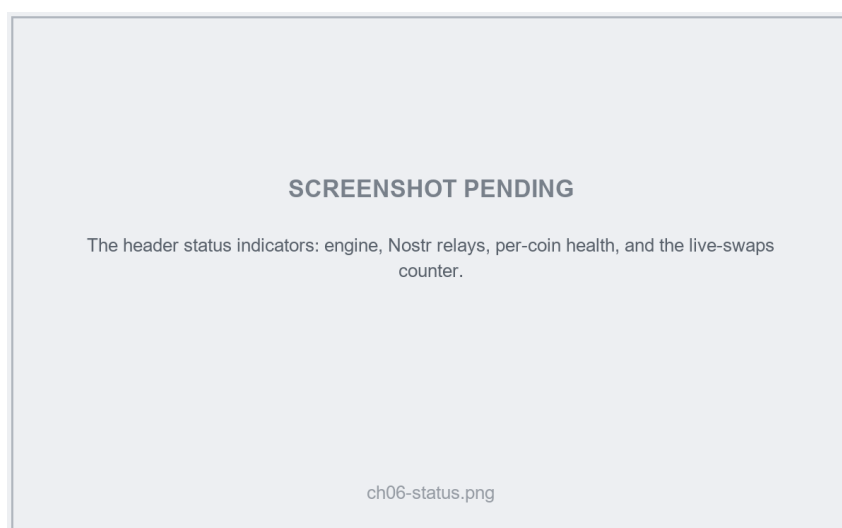


Figure 6.2: The header status indicators: engine, Nostr relays, per-coin health, and the live-swaps counter.

6.4 The network stamp

In the centre of the header you may see a network stamp such as **RegTest** or **TestNet**, reminding you that you are *not* using real funds. On **mainnet** (real coins) this stamp is deliberately hidden — there's nothing to warn you about, because that's the real thing.

Warning — If there's no network stamp, you are on mainnet and trading with real money. Double-check amounts before you confirm anything.

6.5 The activity log and active-swaps dock

While you're on the **Corkboard**, two extra panels are docked along the bottom of the content area (they appear only on that screen):

- **Your active swaps** — a live card for each swap in progress, showing its state, the amounts, your role, and — when needed — the action buttons to push a swap along (fund, redeem, cancel, refund). These buttons appear only when it's your turn to act. The chapter on tracking your swaps explains each one.
- **Activity log** — a running, collapsible feed of what the engine is doing, narrated in plain language. You don't need to watch it, but it's reassuring to glance at when a swap is mid-flight.

That's the whole map. The next chapters take each screen in turn, starting with the Corkboard.

Chapter 7

The Corkboard

The **Corkboard** is where trades live in public. Makers pin offers to it, and you browse those offers and take the one you like. It's the screen Satchel opens on, and it's the heart of the app.

One thing to understand up front: the Corkboard is a *noticeboard*, not an exchange. It never matches buyers with sellers, and it never holds your coins. It simply displays everyone's offers in a tidy, familiar layout so you can find the price you want and take it yourself.

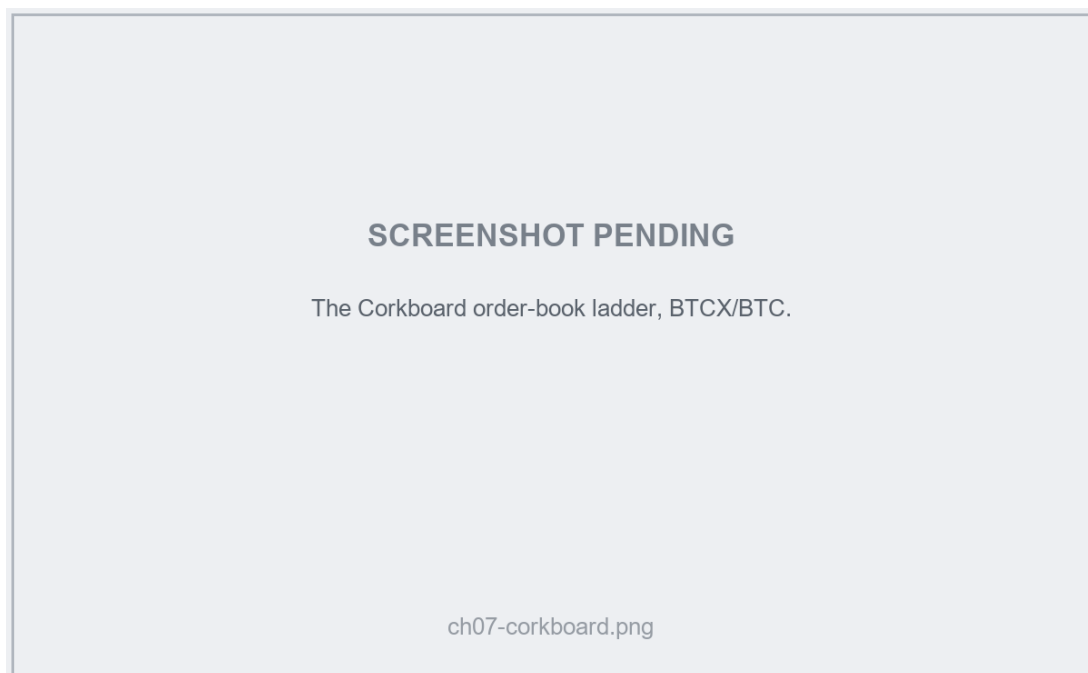


Figure 7.1: The Corkboard order-book ladder, BTCX/BTC.

7.1 The controls along the top

- **Pair selector** — chooses which two coins you're looking at, shown as `SYM ↔ SYM` (for example `BTCX ↔ BTC`). Only pairs whose coins you've set up appear here. Your last choice is remembered.

- **All / Mine** — **All** shows every offer on the board; **Mine** narrows it to just the offers you posted, so you can find and withdraw your own.
- **Denomination toggle** — switches the display unit for the quote coin, so you can read prices in whichever unit you think in.
- **Board selector** — if you've connected more than one noticeboard, this picks which one you're viewing. (You post to all of them at once, but you browse one at a time.)

7.2 Reading the order book

The book has two columns:

- **Bids** are on the **left** and shown in **green**. These are makers who want the base coin and are paying the quote coin for it.
- **Asks** are on the **right** and shown in **red**. These are makers selling the base coin for the quote coin.

Each row is a *price level*. Offers at the exact same rate are grouped together onto one level, so a single row can represent several offers. The **depth bar** behind the row shows how much coin is on offer at that price — a longer bar means more is available there. Within each column the best price sits closest to the centre divider: bids run high-to-low downward, asks run low-to-high.

To keep things readable, Satchel shows the top eight levels per side. If there's more, a **Show more** toggle reveals the rest.

7.2.1 The spread banner

Above the two columns is a small banner describing the gap between the best bid and the best ask:

- A **spread percentage** and a **mid price** when there are offers on both sides.
- **One-sided** when there are offers on only one side.
- A **crossed** chip when the top bid is at or above the top ask.

That last one can look alarming if you're used to an exchange, so here's the key point: **the board never matches trades**. When offers overlap, they simply sit there — nothing fires automatically. You can take either side at the price shown. Crossed just means two makers happen to have posted overlapping prices.

Note — On an exchange, a crossed book would instantly execute. On the Corkboard nothing executes on its own — *you* choose an offer and take it. The ladder is only a way to *read* the board.

7.3 The detail pane: seeing the offers at a level

Clicking a price level fills the **detail pane** below the book with the individual offers sitting at that rate, biggest first. (Before you pick a level, the pane prompts you to "pick a price level above.")

Each offer row shows:

- **The counterparty** — a tag for who posted it, or “your offer” if it’s yours.
- **Amounts from your perspective** — what you would give and what you would receive if you took it. You don’t have to do the maker’s math in reverse; Satchel flips it for you.
- **The protocol chip** — either **Standard (HTLC)** (the classic swap, muted style) or **Private (Taproot)** (the newer private swap, highlighted style). Both are safe; the private one simply looks like an ordinary payment on-chain. See the safety chapter for the difference.
- **The safety-refund times** — shown as t2h / t1h (for example 12h / 24h). These are the auto-refund deadlines that protect you if a swap stalls; the taker’s side unlocks first, the maker’s a little later, so nobody gets stuck.
- **A freshness dot** — how recently the offer was seen, so you can favour live ones.

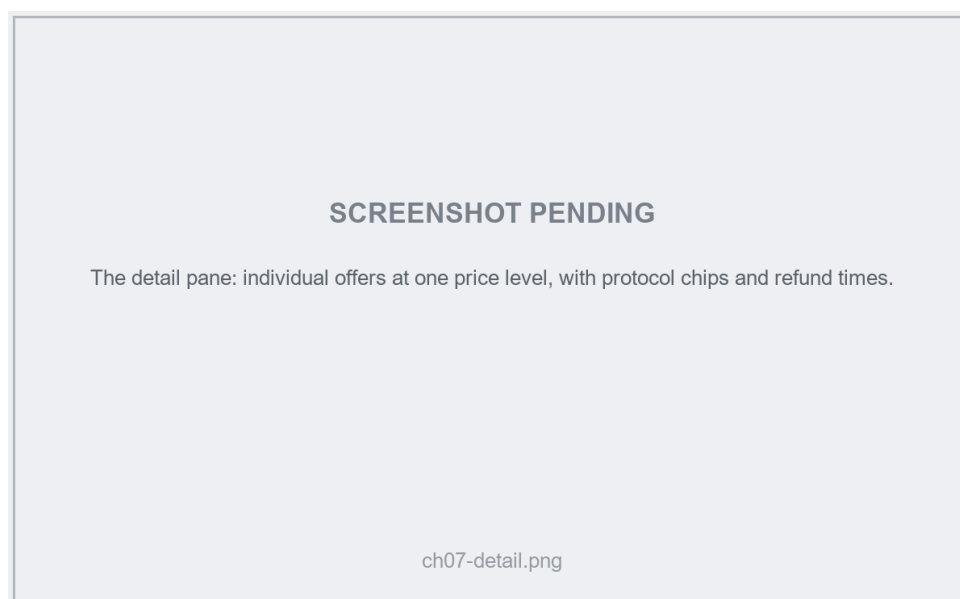


Figure 7.2: The detail pane: individual offers at one price level, with protocol chips and refund times.

7.4 Taking an offer

When you’ve found an offer you like, click **Take offer** on its row. Satchel shows a confirmation dialog summarising the trade — amounts, protocol, refund times, and the network-fee preview — before anything happens. The chapter on taking an offer walks through what comes next.

The **Take offer** button is disabled in two cases:

- **It’s your own offer** — you can’t take yourself. (Use **Withdraw** instead, see below.)
- **A node is down** — if one of the two coins for this pair isn’t reachable, Satchel blocks the take with a note to start the node or check **Settings** → **Coins**. This is a friendly guard; the engine would refuse it anyway.

7.5 Withdrawing your own offer

For an offer you posted, the row shows **Withdraw** instead of **Take offer**. Click it to pull the listing immediately. Because an offer never locks any funds, withdrawing is instant and costs nothing — it just removes the advert.

7.6 Empty and error states

The Corkboard tells you clearly when there's nothing to show:

- **No Corkboard connected** — you haven't pointed Satchel at a noticeboard yet. A **Configure in Settings** link takes you there.
- **No offers you can take right now** — the board is reachable but has no offers for a pair you've set up. They'll appear as soon as a maker posts one, and you can always post your own.
- **More offers for pairs you haven't connected** — a note like "*N* more... Settings → Coins" means there are offers out there for pairs whose coins you haven't connected yet. Set up both coins to see and trade them.

Chapter 8

Making an Offer

Instead of taking someone else's offer, you can post your own and let others come to you. Click **Post an offer** in the left navigation to open the offer form.

Posting an offer locks nothing. It's just a signed advert pinned to the board. A swap only starts when someone takes your offer and both sides fund their legs — and you can withdraw the offer any time before that. So there's no risk in posting; take your time getting the terms right.

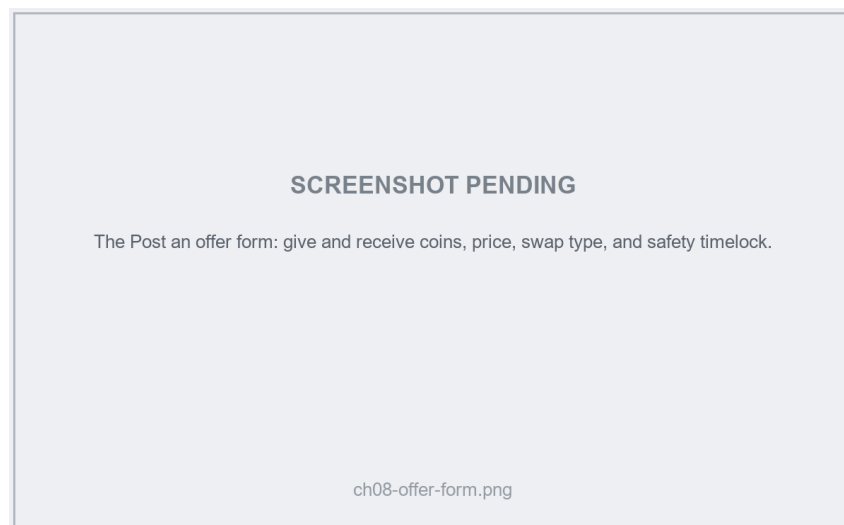


Figure 8.1: The Post an offer form: give and receive coins, price, swap type, and safety timelock.

8.1 Filling in the form

8.1.1 You give / You receive

Pick the coin you're offering under **You give** and the coin you want under **You receive**, each with an amount. Beneath each amount field Satchel shows your **live balance** in that coin (pulled from your own node), so you can see what you have to work with. The two coins must be different, and both their nodes need to be live — if a node is down, Satchel blocks the post and tells you to start it.

8.1.2 Price

The **Price** field lets you work the way an exchange does: enter a unit price and one amount, and Satchel fills in the other amount for you. It works in both directions — type the receive amount and it back-fills the price. The label under the field reminds you of the units (quote coin per give coin).

8.1.3 Swap type

If the pair you chose supports more than one kind of swap, a **Swap type** dropdown appears so you can pick:

- **Standard (HTLC)** — the classic atomic swap.
- **Private (Taproot)** — a newer style that looks like an ordinary payment on-chain.

If the pair only supports one type, Satchel just shows it as a line of text — there's nothing to choose. Both are equally safe; the safety chapter explains the difference.

8.1.4 Safety timelock

The **Safety timelock** is the auto-refund window: if a swap stalls, this is how long before your funds automatically come back to you. Rather than ask you for raw block times, Satchel offers three presets:

Preset	Refund times (t2 / t1)	What it means
Short	~6h / ~12h	Funds auto-refund fastest if a trade stalls — but the smallest safety margin.
Medium (default)	~12h / ~24h	A balanced window. Recommended for most trades.
Long	~18h / ~36h	The widest safety margin; auto-refund takes longest if a trade stalls.

The two numbers are the two sides' refund deadlines (the taker's leg unlocks at the shorter one, yours at the longer). A **shorter** timelock gets your money back faster if something goes wrong, but leaves a thinner margin for the swap to complete normally. A **longer** one is the safest choice but means a stalled swap takes longer to unwind. When in doubt, leave it on **Medium**.

Tip — The timelock only matters if a swap *stalls*. A normal swap completes in minutes; the timelock is purely the safety net.

8.1.5 Valid for (minutes)

Valid for sets how long the offer stays listed, in minutes (default 60). While Satchel is open, the engine keeps the listing fresh automatically; once the window passes, the offer expires. Closing the app also withdraws it.

8.2 Reviewing and confirming

When the form is complete, click **Post offer**. Satchel shows a **review dialog** before anything goes out, summarising:

- what you give and what you receive,
- the swap type,
- the safety-refund window (t_{2h} / t_{1h}),
- how long the offer is valid, and
- a **network-cost preview** so you know roughly what the on-chain fees will be.

Check it over, then confirm.

Note — There are **no platform fees**. The Corkboard charges nothing to post or trade. The only cost is the ordinary on-chain mining fee you'd pay for any Bitcoin-style transaction, and that's only paid once a swap actually runs.

8.3 What happens after you post

Your offer **fans out to all of your noticeboards at once** — every Corkboard and every Nostr relay you've configured — so the widest possible audience can see it. Satchel then takes you to the Corkboard, where your own offer is marked with a "your offer" tag and a "mine here" dot at its price level.

From there you simply wait. If someone takes your offer, a swap begins and you'll see it in **Your active swaps** and on the **Swaps** page. If you change your mind first, find the offer (the **Mine** filter helps) and click **Withdraw** — it's instant and free.

Chapter 9

Taking an Offer & How a Swap Runs

This chapter follows what happens from the moment you take an offer to the moment the swap completes. The good news is short: once you confirm, the engine does the work. You don't have to babysit it.

9.1 Taking an offer from the Corkboard

On the Corkboard, open the price level you want, find the offer, and click **Take offer**. Satchel shows a **confirmation dialog** before committing anything. It lays out:

- **You give** and **You receive** — the exact amounts, from your side.
- **Counterparty** — who you'd be trading with.
- **The protocol** — **Standard (HTLC)** or **Private (Taproot)**.
- **Safety refund** — the auto-refund deadlines (τ_{2h} / τ_{1h}).
- **A network-cost preview** — the on-chain fees you'll pay.

Crucially, it also reassures you about order of operations: *the maker locks their coins first — you never send first*. You can still cancel before you fund your own side, and if anything stalls the engine auto-refunds you after the safety timelock.

Read it over and confirm. The swap is now under way.

9.2 How the swap runs, in plain language

A swap is an *atomic* trade: either both sides happen, or neither does. There's no moment where one person has both coins. Here's the sequence, without the cryptography:

1. **The maker funds first.** The party who posted the offer locks their coins on their chain before you lock anything. You are never the one exposed first.
2. **The engine watches both chains.** Satchel's engine monitors the blockchains for both coins, waiting for each funding to confirm to a safe depth.
3. **The funds are released atomically.** Once both sides are locked, the engine completes the exchange so that each of you can only claim your coin in a way that simultaneously

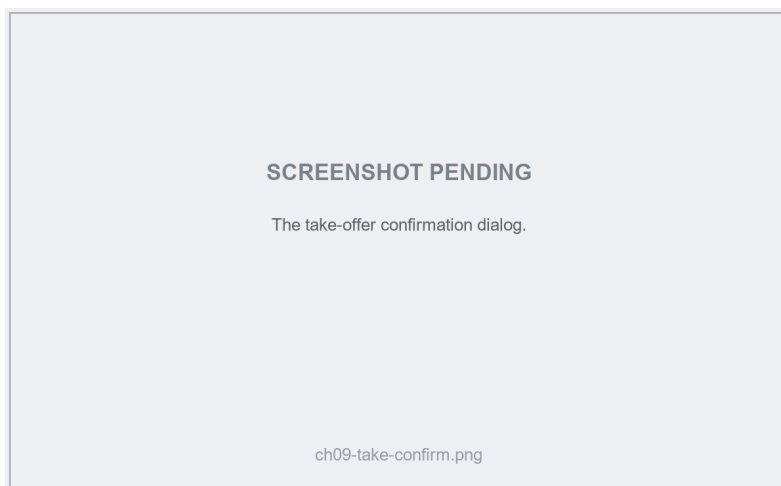


Figure 9.1: The take-offer confirmation dialog.

lets the other claim theirs. Neither side can run off with both.

4. **If anything stalls, you're auto-refunded.** If a counterparty disappears or a chain gets stuck, the engine waits for the safety timelock and then automatically pulls your locked funds back to you. You don't have to do anything to get a refund — it's built in.

Note — The whole flow is automatic. You generally won't touch a button. When the app *does* need you (for example, to fund your side), the action appears in the active-swaps dock — see the chapter on tracking your swaps.

9.3 You don't have to babysit it — but keep the app running

You don't need to sit and watch a swap. But the **engine must keep running** until the swap finishes, because it's the engine that redeems or refunds at the right moment. Those moments are governed by on-chain timelocks with real deadlines.

If you try to close Satchel while a swap is live, it offers to **Keep running** — this leaves the engine working quietly in the background (even with the window closed) so the swap finishes on its own. This is the recommended choice. You can reopen Satchel any time to check progress.

Warning — Force-quitting in the middle of a swap stops the engine and can lose funds, because nothing is left running to redeem or refund before the deadline. Always choose **Keep running** when prompted. The exit dialog is covered in the chapter on tracking your swaps.

9.4 Where to go next

- To watch a swap progress and act on it if needed, see the chapter **Tracking Your Swaps**.
- For the reassurance of *why* this is safe — what atomic means, what the timelocks guarantee — see the safety chapter.

If you're curious about the cryptographic machinery (HTLCs, adaptor signatures, the actual scripts), that's all in the companion **Pact** handbook. You don't need any of it to trade safely.

Chapter 10

Tracking Your Swaps

Once a swap is under way, you can follow it from start to finish. There are two places to look: the **Swaps** page, which is your read-only ledger, and the **active-swaps dock** under the Corkboard, which is where the occasional action buttons live.

10.1 The Swaps page

Click **Swaps** in the left navigation. This page is a **read-only ledger** — it shows you everything but has no action buttons (those live in the Corkboard dock, covered below). It's split into two sections, newest first:

- **In flight** — swaps currently running.
- **History** — swaps that have finished, refunded, or been aborted.

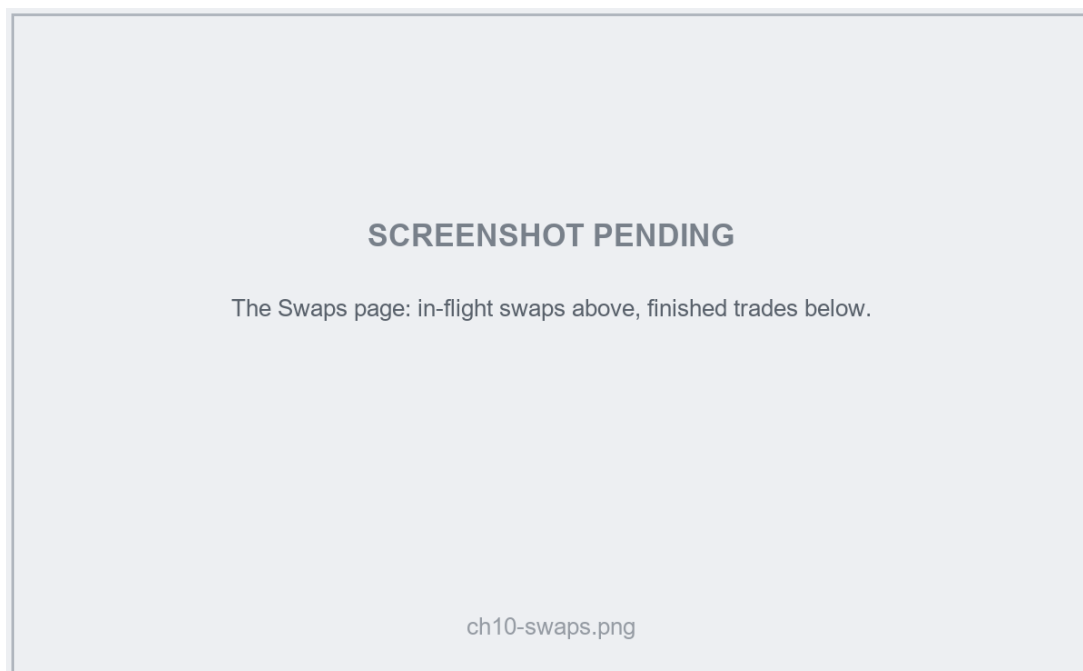


Figure 10.1: The Swaps page: in-flight swaps above, finished trades below.

10.1.1 The columns

Each row shows:

Column	What it tells you
swap	The swap's short id.
role	Whether you were the maker or the taker.
state	Where the swap is in its lifecycle.
gives → receives	What you gave and what you got.
when	The timestamp.
final tx	The settling transaction once it completes.

Private swaps carry a **Private (Taproot)** chip so you can tell them apart at a glance.

10.1.2 Reading the state

The **state** is colour-coded so you can scan the page quickly:

- **Completed** — green. The swap finished and you received your coins.
- **Refunded** — amber. The swap didn't complete, so your locked funds came back to you. No loss.
- **Aborted** — red. The swap was cancelled before any funds were locked.

Alongside the state, Satchel shows the engine's own narration — a plain-language, verbatim description of what happened at each step. This is the same calm, running commentary you see in the activity log.

10.1.3 On-chain detail

Each swap row can be expanded to reveal its **on-chain detail** — the audit trail. This shows both funding transactions and *your* settlement or refund (never the counterparty's settlement, and never the swap secret). Each transaction id has a **copy** button, so you can paste it into a block explorer if you ever want to see it on-chain yourself.

Tip — You never *need* to check a block explorer; the swap completes on its own. The on-chain detail is there for peace of mind and your own records.

If you have no swaps yet, the page simply says so and points you to the Corkboard to take your first offer.

10.2 Where the actions live: the active-swaps dock

The Swaps page shows you everything but doesn't have buttons. The handful of actions a swap might ask of you live in the **active-swaps dock**, which is docked under the **Corkboard**. Each live swap gets a card there with its state, amounts, your role, the engine's narration, and a "refund *when*" note.

The action buttons appear **only when it's your turn**, gated by the swap's state:

Button	When it appears	What it does
fund	When it's your turn to lock your side	Funds your leg of the swap.
redeem	When the other side has funded and you can claim	Claims your coins.
cancel	Before you've funded anything	Abandons the swap; you lose nothing, since nothing of yours is locked.
refund	After the safety timelock has passed on a leg you funded	Pulls your locked funds back now.

Each button shows a confirmation dialog first. In normal operation the engine handles funding, redeeming, and refunding **automatically** — you'll rarely press anything. The buttons are there for the cases where you want to act manually, for example to cancel early or to refund the instant the timelock allows rather than waiting for the engine's automatic pass.

Note — **cancel** is only offered while nothing of yours is locked, so it's always safe — the offer simply won't complete. **refund** only appears once the timelock has passed, and the engine also fires it automatically after the deadline, so you're covered either way.

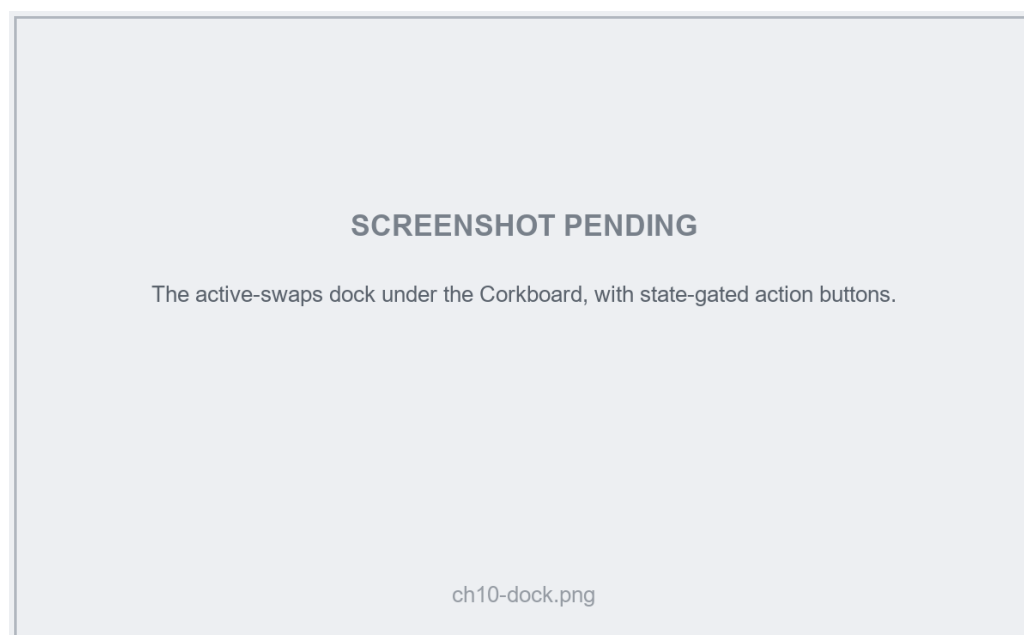


Figure 10.2: The active-swaps dock under the Corkboard, with state-gated action buttons.

10.3 Closing the app mid-swap: the exit gate

If you try to close Satchel while a swap is in flight, an **exit gate** dialog stops you and explains the situation: the swap is governed by on-chain timelocks, and the engine must keep running to redeem or refund before the deadline.

Your choices:

- **Keep running, close window** (recommended) — the window closes but the engine keeps working in the background until the swap finishes. Reopen Satchel any time to check on it.
- **Cancel** — go back; don't close after all.
- **Force-quit** — stops the engine entirely. This is deliberately hard: you must type the word QUIT to confirm, and the dialog warns you in plain terms that doing so can lose funds.

Warning — Choose **Keep running** whenever a swap is live. **Force-quit** kills the engine mid-flight, and with nothing left to redeem or refund before the timelock, funds can be lost. Only force-quit when you have no swaps in flight.

If instead you only have *offers* posted (no live swap), the exit gate is gentler: it lets you withdraw your offers and exit, or keep the engine running so counterparties can still take them while Satchel is closed.

Chapter 11

Your Wallets

The **Wallets** page gives you a quick, at-a-glance balance for each coin you've connected. Click **Wallets** in the left navigation to open it.

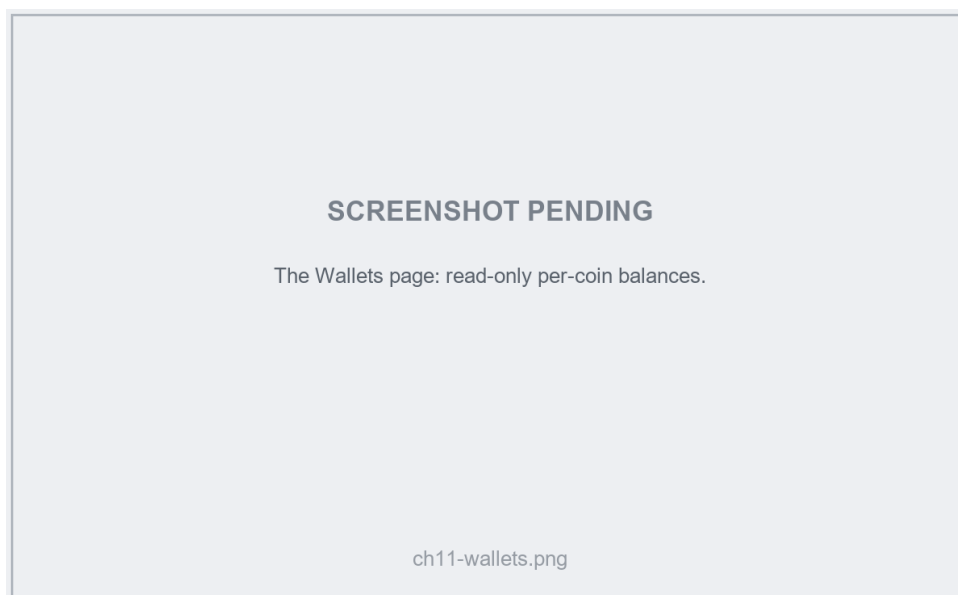


Figure 11.1: The Wallets page: read-only per-coin balances.

You'll see one card per configured coin, each with the coin's icon, name, symbol, and a large balance figure. The balances come live from your own coin nodes.

11.1 Why it's read-only

There's no **Send** or **Receive** button here, and that's on purpose. These aren't wallets that Satchel owns — **they are the wallets of your own nodes**, the same nodes the engine uses to fund swaps and receive proceeds. Your keys, your machine; Satchel never holds your coins.

Because the coins live in your node's own wallet, sending and receiving already belongs to your node's own software — Satchel duplicating it would just be a second, confusing front end for the same wallet. And the transactions that *do* matter for trading — your funding and settlement

— already appear on the **Swaps** page with full on-chain detail. So the Wallets page sticks to what Satchel is best placed to show you: a clean balance readout.

Note — A full send/receive wallet *is* planned, but it arrives with the future **node-less** build of Satchel — a version that carries its own wallet instead of leaning on a separate node. Until then, use your node software to move coins.

11.2 The hot-seed warning

At the top of the page is a warning banner reminding you that a merchant's seed is a **hot** spending seed, not a vault. It holds transit keys for in-flight swaps, which means it has to be available and unencrypted enough for the engine to act quickly.

Warning — Don't park large balances in a merchant wallet. Sweep sizable proceeds to your own cold or main wallet after a trade. The merchant seed is hot by design — treat it as a working float, not savings.

11.3 Loading and error states

The balance on each card updates independently, so one coin having trouble never blocks the others:

- ... — the balance is still loading.
- – — Satchel couldn't read this coin's balance. Hover the dash for a tooltip explaining the error; usually it means that coin's node is unreachable, so start it (or check **Settings** → **Coins**).

If you haven't connected a merchant yet, or haven't set up any coins, the page shows a short prompt with a link to **Coins** in Settings rather than empty cards.

Chapter 12

Private (Off-Market) Offers

Sometimes you don't want to post to the whole board — you want to trade with one specific person. Maybe you've agreed a price with a friend, or you simply prefer not to advertise. *Private offers* let you do exactly that. Instead of pinning an offer to the Corkboard, you create a small code called a **slip** and hand it to your counterparty directly.

A slip is the same kind of signed offer you'd post publicly — it's just delivered person-to-person instead of broadcast. The swap that results is identical: still atomic, still auto-refunding, still safe.

12.1 Creating a slip

1. Click **Create slip** in the left navigation.
2. Fill in the **same offer form** you'd use to post publicly — coins, amounts, price, swap type, safety timelock. (See the chapter on making an offer for the field-by-field details.)
3. Review and confirm. Satchel produces a slip: a string that begins with `pactoffer1:`, shown in a copyable box.
4. Click **Copy** and send the slip to your counterparty over **any chat** — messaging app, email, whatever you both use. Satchel doesn't send it for you.

The slip box also notes that it **expires in about 24 hours**. After that it's no good and your counterparty will have to ask for a fresh one.

12.2 Taking a slip

If someone sends *you* a slip:

1. Click **Take a slip** in the left navigation.
2. Paste the `pactoffer1:` string into the box.
3. Click **Review & take**. Satchel decodes it, shows you the same take confirmation dialog you'd get from a board offer (amounts, protocol, refund times, fees), and re-checks the maker's signature.
4. Confirm. From there it's an ordinary swap — follow it on the **Swaps** page.

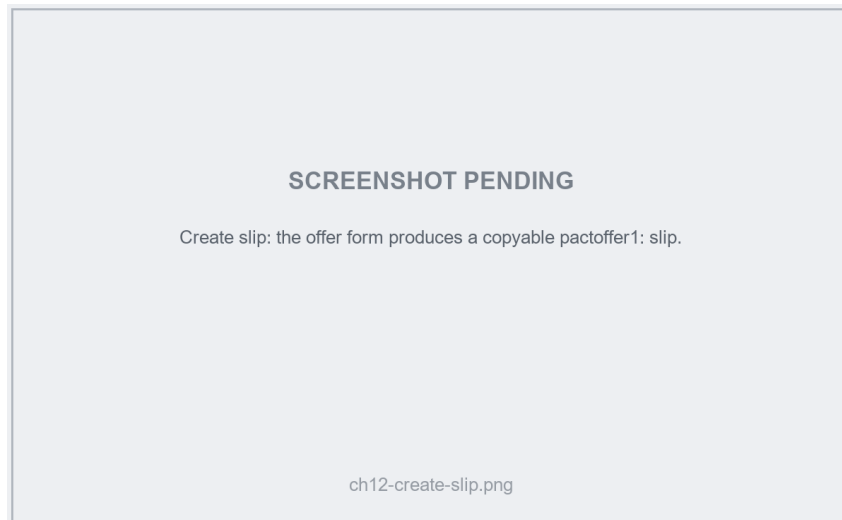


Figure 12.1: Create slip: the offer form produces a copyable pactoffer1: slip.

12.3 Tracking your slips: My slips

Click **My slips** to see the private offers you've handed out. Each card shows the amounts and a countdown to expiry, with a **Cancel** button.

Cancelling stops you honouring that slip: a friend who still holds it can no longer take it. (Slips also expire on their own after roughly 24 hours, so an unused one lapses even if you forget.) If you have no slips out, the screen offers a button to create one.

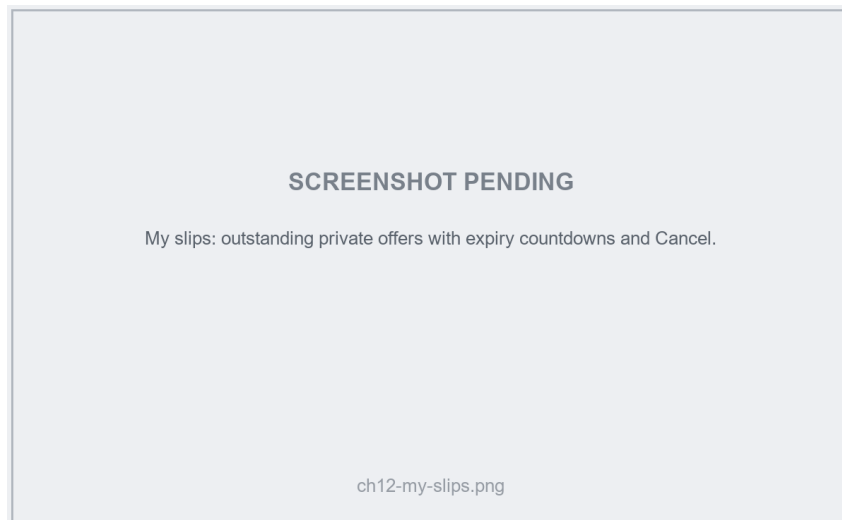


Figure 12.2: My slips: outstanding private offers with expiry countdowns and Cancel.

12.4 A note on slip safety: bearer offers

A slip is a *bearer* instrument: **whoever holds it can take it**, until it expires or you cancel it. There's no name baked into a slip — if you forward it to the wrong person, or it's intercepted, they could take it on the agreed terms.

That sounds scarier than it is, because of what a slip *can't* do:

- **The terms are fixed.** A slip locks in the exact coins, amounts, price, and timelock. Nobody can take it for different terms than you set.
- **The swap is still atomic.** Whoever takes it, the trade either completes for both sides or refunds — nobody can take your funds without giving you theirs.
- **You can cancel.** Use **My slips** → **Cancel** any time before it's taken, and it becomes worthless.

Tip — Treat a slip like a price you've quoted to one person: only send it to the counterparty you meant, and cancel it if plans change. The worst case is that someone else accepts the *exact trade you offered* — never a worse one.

12.5 When to use private versus public

- **Post an offer (public)** when you want the best chance of a fill and don't mind the offer being visible. The whole board can take it.
- **Create slip (private)** when you've already agreed terms with someone, or you'd rather not advertise — an over-the-counter, trade-with-a-friend deal.

Either way the protection is the same. Private offers change *who can see the offer*, not *how safe the swap is*.

Part III

Transports & Network

Chapter 13

Trading over Nostr & Corkboard

When you post an offer, it has to reach other people somehow. Satchel uses a *noticeboard* for this — a public place where offers are pinned up so others can browse them. Think of a physical cork noticeboard in a town square: you tack up a card saying what you want to trade, people walk past and read it, and someone who likes the deal takes your card down and contacts you.

Satchel can use two kinds of noticeboard, and they work side by side. You don't have to choose — and most people never think about this screen at all, because the default just works.

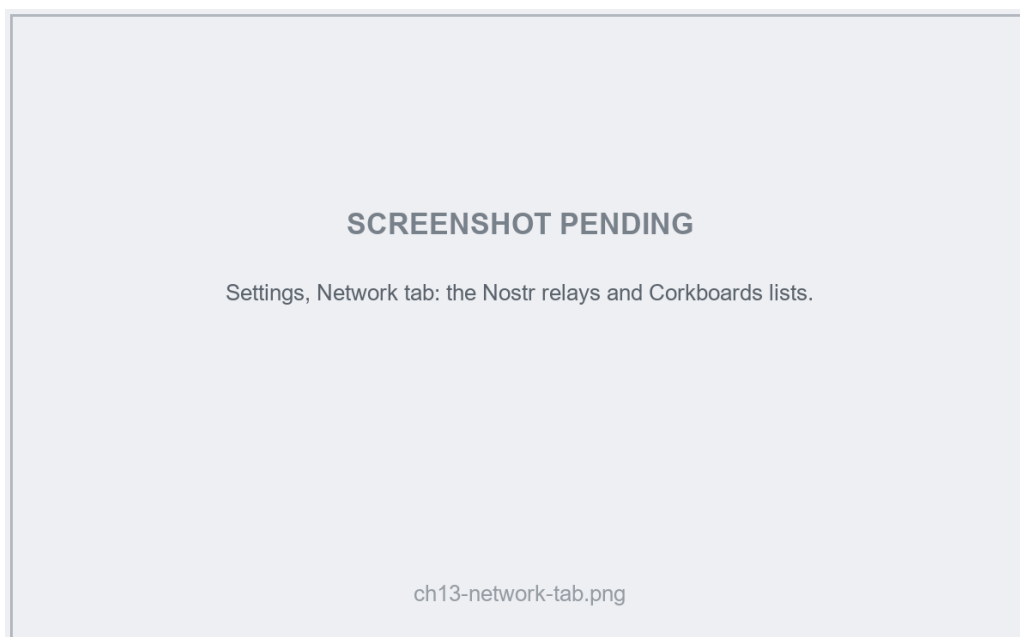


Figure 13.1: Settings, Network tab: the Nostr relays and Corkboards lists.

13.1 The two kinds of noticeboard

13.1.1 Nostr — the default, nothing to run

Nostr is an open, public messaging network made up of independent servers called *relays*. It is not owned by anyone; anybody can run a relay, and they all speak the same simple language.

Satchel uses Nostr as its default noticeboard, and **it is ready the moment you install** — there is nothing for you to set up or run.

A fresh copy of Satchel comes with **six recommended relays already wired in**. When you post an offer, Satchel sends a copy to *all* of them at once. This is deliberate. If one relay is slow, offline, or decides to ignore you, the others still carry your offer — so no single server can quietly silence you. People call this *censorship-resistance*, and it is the main reason Nostr is the default.

Note — The six default relays are public, community-run servers on the open Nostr network. You can change the list, add your own, or remove ones you don't like in **Settings** → **Network**. The chapter “*Settings*” shows you how.

You can tell Nostr is working from the small **relay dot** in the header at the top of the window. Green means at least one relay is reachable; amber means none are responding right now. The dot only appears when you have relays configured.

13.1.2 Corkboard — a noticeboard a community can run

A *Corkboard* is a small, self-hostable noticeboard. A community, a club, or a group of friends can run one on a server they control, and then everyone points their Satchel at its web address. It is the same idea as Nostr — a public list of signed offers — but it lives at one address that the community owns and operates.

Corkboard is **opt-in**: a fresh install has none configured. If your community runs one, someone will give you its URL (a web address like `https://board.example.com`). You add it in **Settings** → **Network**, Satchel checks it, and from then on your offers appear there too.

Tip — Corkboard is handy when you want a smaller, more focused marketplace — say, just the members of one community — rather than the wide-open Nostr network. You can run both at once.

13.2 How they work together

The two kinds of noticeboard are equal partners. Here's the simple model:

- **Posting fans out to everything.** When you post an offer, Satchel sends it to *every* noticeboard you have configured — all your Nostr relays *and* every Corkboard at once. You post once; it lands everywhere.
- **Browsing shows one at a time.** When you look at the **Corkboard** screen, you are looking at *one* board's offers. A board selector lets you switch between them — your Nostr offers, or a particular Corkboard — so you can see who is trading where.

Because posting fans out but browsing is per-board, there is one rule worth remembering:

Note — You and the person you want to trade with only need **one noticeboard in common**. If you both have Nostr enabled (the default), you're already covered. If

your community runs a Corkboard and you've both added it, that works too. You don't need to match every board — just one.

13.3 What a noticeboard can and cannot see

This is the part that matters most, so it's worth being clear. A noticeboard — whether a Nostr relay or a Corkboard — is a **dumb pinboard**. It carries two kinds of thing, and nothing else:

1. **Your public offers**, which are signed by you. An offer says "I'll give X for Y, valid for an hour" — and it is *meant* to be public, so people can find and take it. Anyone can read it; only you could have created it.
2. **Sealed messages** passed between two traders mid-swap. These are *encrypted* before they ever leave your machine. The board stores them and hands them on, but it cannot open them.

What a noticeboard **never** sees:

- **Your keys.** Your private keys and recovery phrase never leave your computer. Nothing on a board can derive them.
- **Your coins.** A noticeboard holds no money. It cannot touch your funds, and there is nothing in your wallet for it to take.
- **The contents of sealed messages.** Mid-swap messages are encrypted to the recipient only. The board sees scrambled bytes — not who said what.

And just as importantly, a noticeboard **cannot match you with anyone or execute a trade**. It has no power to pair offers, move coins, or settle a swap. All of that happens directly between you and your counterparty, enforced by the blockchains themselves (the chapter "*Understanding Atomic Swaps*" explains how). The board is only a place to find each other.

Warning — Treat every offer on a noticeboard as a *claim*, not a promise. The board does not vet anyone. Your safety never comes from trusting the board or the other trader — it comes from the swap itself, which is built so that either both sides get paid or neither does. Always confirm the amounts and the safety timelock in the take dialog before you commit.

13.4 Do I need to think about any of this?

Usually not. For most people the honest answer is: **install Satchel and start trading**. Nostr is on by default with six relays prewired, so you have a working noticeboard from minute one. You only need to open **Settings** → **Network** if you want to add a community Corkboard, trim the relay list, or turn Nostr off entirely — all of which the next chapter, "*Settings*", walks through.

Chapter 14

Settings

Everything you can configure in Satchel lives behind the **Settings** gear, which you'll find in the top-right header and again at the foot of the left-hand navigation. Settings is organised into four tabs — **General**, **Coins**, **Network**, and **About** — and this chapter takes them in turn.

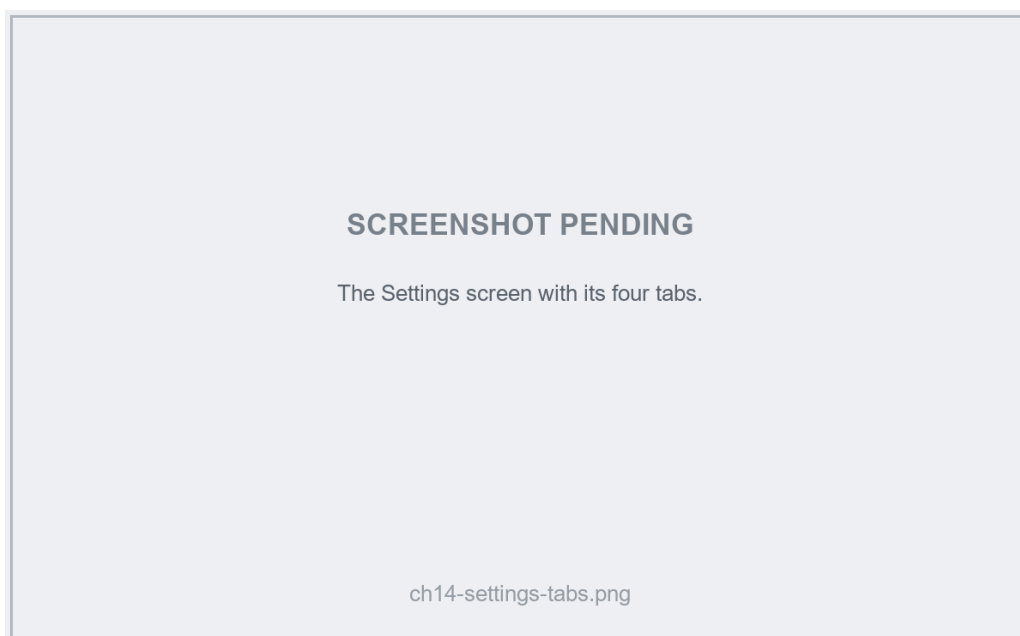


Figure 14.1: The Settings screen with its four tabs.

Most of what's here you'll set once and forget. None of it touches your coins or your recovery phrase — these are preferences and connection details, nothing more.

14.1 General

The **General** tab holds your look-and-feel preferences.

- **Theme** — choose **Light**, **Dark**, or **System**. **System** follows whatever your computer is set to (dark in the evening, light by day, if your OS does that). The change applies instantly and is remembered next time you open the app.

- **Language** — selects the app’s display language. At the moment **English** is the only language available; more may come later.

Tip — There’s also a quick theme and language reach from the header, but the **General** tab is the canonical place to set them.

14.2 Coins

The **Coins** tab is where you tell Satchel how to reach the cryptocurrency nodes you trade with — your Bitcoin node, your BTCX node, and so on. Because this is a big topic with its own setup flow, it has a dedicated chapter.

Note — See the chapter “*Setting Up Your Coins*” for the full walkthrough: adding a coin, entering its connection details, validating it, and reading the status pills and trading-pair list. The same screen appears both there and here under **Settings** → **Coins**.

In short: each coin shows a status pill — **Not set up**, **Connected**, or **Connection error** — and a **Set up** or **Edit connection** button. Below the coins, a **Trading pairs** list tells you which pairs are ready to trade.

14.3 Network

The **Network** tab controls your noticeboards — the places your offers are posted and browsed. (For the bigger picture of how these work, see the chapter “*Trading over Nostr & Corkboard*”.) It shows your current network at the top, and then two editable lists.

14.3.1 Nostr relays

This is the list of *Nostr relays* — the public servers that carry your offers on the open Nostr network. A fresh install arrives with six recommended relays already in the list, so you normally don’t need to touch this.

- To **add** a relay, type its address. A valid relay address starts with `wss://` (for example `wss://relay.damus.io`). Satchel checks the format as you type.
- To **remove** one, delete it from the list.

Note — If you clear the Nostr relays list completely, **Nostr is turned off**. That’s a valid choice — for instance, if you only ever trade over a private Corkboard — but with an empty list your offers won’t reach the open Nostr network at all.

14.3.2 Corkboards

This is the list of *Corkboard* noticeboards — the self-hostable boards a community might run. A fresh install has none; you add one only if you have its address.

- To **add** a Corkboard, type its web address. A valid Corkboard address starts with `https://` (or `http://`). If the list is empty, the field reads **None configured** — which is perfectly fine.
- To **remove** one, delete it from the list.

14.3.3 Saving your changes

Both lists are edited together. When you're happy, press **Save & reconnect**. Satchel saves the new relay and Corkboard lists and reconnects to them right away — you'll see the header's relay dot update to reflect what's now reachable.

Tip — If a freshly added relay or board shows amber or red after saving, double-check the address for a typo. The chapter *"Troubleshooting"* has a short section on noticeboards that won't connect.

14.4 About

The **About** tab is your reference corner.

- **Version** — the exact Satchel version you're running, with an **Up to date** badge or an update notice. If a newer release exists, Satchel tells you here (and with a small badge by the logo in the navigation); use **Check for updates** to look again.
- **Where your keys live** — a short trust note reminding you that your keys and recovery phrase stay on your own machine and are never sent to Satchel, to any noticeboard, or to anyone else.
- **Risk disclaimer** — the alpha-software notice. Satchel is early-release software under active development and external security review; trade with funds you're prepared to put at risk while it matures.

14.5 Where your settings are stored

All of these preferences — your theme, language, coin connections, relay list, and Corkboard list — are saved in a small file named `satchel1.json` on your own computer. Nothing is stored in the cloud or on any server.

Note — `satchel1.json` holds *settings only* — never your recovery phrase or any private key. Those are handled separately and far more carefully; the chapter *"Backup, Seeds & Safety"* explains exactly where they live.

Part IV

Safety & Reference

Chapter 15

Backup, Seeds & Safety

This is the most important chapter in the book. Trustless trading puts you in complete control of your money — and that control comes with responsibility. No company holds your coins, so no company can lose them, freeze them, or hand them to a thief. The flip side is that **no one can recover them for you, either**. Almost all of your safety comes down to one small list of words and a few simple habits. Please read this chapter slowly.

15.1 Your recovery phrase

When you create a trading identity, Satchel shows you a *recovery phrase* — a list of 12 or 24 ordinary words, in a specific order. (You may also hear it called a *seed* or *seed phrase*; they're the same thing.) Those words *are* your wallet. Everything Satchel does on your behalf — your trading keys, your addresses, your ability to refund a swap — is mathematically derived from them. Lose the words and you lose access; let someone else have them and they have your money.

There are exactly two rules. They are non-negotiable.

Warning — Write your recovery phrase down on paper the moment Satchel shows it to you, and store it somewhere safe and private — ideally more than one place. This is the *only* way to recover your funds if your computer is lost, stolen, or breaks. Do it before you click past the screen.

Warning — Never type or paste your recovery phrase into any website, chat, email, or “support” form. Ever. Anyone who gets those words can take everything, instantly and irreversibly. No genuine support person, and no one from this project, will *ever* ask you for it. Satchel itself only ever asks for it on its own first-run screen, never on a web page.

A few practical do's and don'ts:

- **Do** write it by hand on paper (or stamp it into metal, if you want it fireproof). Pen and paper beats a screenshot.

- **Don't** take a photo of it, save it in a notes app, email it to yourself, or store it in a password manager that syncs to the cloud. Each of those is a copy a thief could reach.
- **Do** double-check you copied every word correctly and in order before you continue. Satchel asks you to confirm a few of the words for exactly this reason.

15.2 Encrypting with a passphrase

When you set up your identity, Satchel offers to protect your seed with a *passphrase* — a password of your choosing. This is **optional but strongly recommended**, especially on a computer others might use.

Here's what the passphrase does and doesn't do:

- **It protects the copy of your seed on this computer.** With encryption on, your seed is stored scrambled, and Satchel asks for your passphrase once each session to unlock it. Someone who steals your laptop can't trade or drain your funds without it.
- **It is not your recovery phrase, and it is not a backup.** The passphrase only guards the local copy. Your recovery phrase is still what restores your funds anywhere.

Warning — If you forget your passphrase, **Satchel cannot reset or recover it** — there's no "forgot password" link, by design. You would need to restore from your recovery phrase to set a new one. So: choose a passphrase you'll remember, and keep your written recovery phrase safe as your ultimate fallback.

15.3 What the engine holds, and what never leaves your machine

Behind Satchel runs *the engine* (its technical name is `pactd`). The engine is the trustworthy worker that does the real swap work on your computer:

- It holds your **keys**, unlocked in memory for the session, and signs transactions with them.
- It **builds and watches** your swaps from start to finish, broadcasting the right transaction at the right moment.
- It **auto-refunds** you if a swap doesn't complete (more on that below).

Crucially, all of this happens **locally, on your machine**. What is *never* sent to any server, noticeboard, or other person:

- your recovery phrase and private keys;
- your passphrase;
- the contents of your wallet.

The only things that ever go out are your **public, signed offers** (which are meant to be seen) and **encrypted messages** to your counterparty mid-swap (which the noticeboard can't read). See the chapter "*Trading over Nostr & Corkboard*" for exactly what a board can and can't see.

15.4 Keep Satchel running until a swap completes

This rule prevents the most avoidable kind of loss.

Warning — **While a swap is in progress, keep Satchel (and your nodes) running.**

A swap is a sequence of timed on-chain steps, and the engine has to be awake to broadcast each transaction — including the refund — at the right moment. If you close everything mid-swap, those steps can't fire on time.

A swap isn't instant: each side locks funds on a blockchain, waits for confirmations, and then claims. The engine babysits all of this for you, but it can only do so while it's running. This is why, when you try to quit during a live swap, Satchel stops you with a clear warning and offers to **Keep running** in the background instead. Take that option.

Tip — If you genuinely must shut the machine down, the **Keep running** choice on quit lets the engine continue in the background. And even in the worst case, your seed and the swap's timelocks protect your funds — see *"If your machine dies mid-swap"* below.

15.5 A note on hot seeds

When you open the **Wallets** screen, a banner reminds you that these balances belong to your own nodes' wallets, and nudges you about *hot seeds*. A "hot" seed is simply one that lives on an internet-connected, running machine — which is exactly what a live trader needs. That's normal and fine, but it carries the usual caution:

Warning — Don't keep more on a hot, always-on trading machine than you're comfortable having exposed. Treat your trading balance like the cash in your pocket, not your life savings. Keep long-term holdings in cold storage (an offline wallet), and move funds to your trading machine as you need them.

15.6 If your machine dies mid-swap

Hardware fails, power cuts happen, laptops get left on trains. Here's the reassuring part: **a swap is built so a dead machine can't cost you your funds.** Two safety nets are always in place.

1. **Your recovery phrase rebuilds everything.** Because every key and every swap detail is derived from your seed, you can install Satchel on a new machine, restore from your recovery phrase, reconnect your nodes, and the engine can pick the swap back up.
2. **The timelock guarantees a refund.** Every swap has a built-in deadline called a *timelock*. If the swap doesn't complete, the funds you locked become refundable to you after that deadline passes — automatically, once the engine is running again. Nobody can take your locked funds before then, and you can always reclaim them after.

So the recovery procedure is simply: restore from your recovery phrase on a working machine, reconnect your coins, and let the engine run. It will complete the swap if it still can, or refund

you once the timelock allows. The chapter “*Understanding Atomic Swaps*” explains why this is guaranteed rather than just hoped-for.

Note — This is the whole reason the two rules at the top of this chapter matter so much. The timelock protects funds that are *locked in a swap*; your recovery phrase protects *everything*. With both, a lost computer is an inconvenience, not a disaster. Without your recovery phrase, it’s a disaster. Write it down.

Chapter 16

Understanding Atomic Swaps

You can trade happily with Satchel without ever reading this chapter — the app handles the machinery for you. But many people sleep better once they understand *why* a trade with a stranger is safe even though there's no exchange in the middle. That's what this chapter is for. It's conceptual and friendly; if you want the real cryptography, the companion *Pact Developer & Integrator Handbook* has every byte.

16.1 The problem: trading without trust

Imagine you want to swap some BTCX for someone else's BTC. You've never met them. Whoever sends first is taking a risk: what if the other person just keeps the coins and vanishes? On a traditional exchange, a company sits in the middle holds both sides' money and makes sure the trade is fair — but then you have to trust *that company* not to lose, freeze, or steal your funds.

An *atomic swap* removes the middleman without adding that risk. "Atomic" means **all-or-nothing**: the trade is built so that either *both* sides receive their coins, or *neither* does. There is no in-between where one person walks away with both halves.

16.2 How "all-or-nothing" works

The trick is to **link the two payments together** so that claiming one automatically makes the other claimable. Picture two locked boxes — one holding your BTCX, one holding their BTC — fitted with a clever shared lock. The moment one box is opened, opening it reveals the secret that unlocks the other. Neither box can be opened on its own.

So the sequence is safe at every step:

- Both sides lock their coins into these linked arrangements on their respective blockchains. Locked funds can't be spent by anyone yet.
- When the first party claims their side, the act of claiming **reveals a secret** on the blockchain.
- The other party sees that secret and uses it to claim their side.

If everyone plays along, both get paid. And if someone tries to cheat by claiming their half without letting the other claim theirs — the maths simply doesn't allow it. The very action that releases one half is what makes the other half releasable.

Note — Crucially, the blockchains themselves enforce all of this. No noticeboard, no server, and no person can override it. That's why your safety never depends on trusting the board or the other trader.

16.3 The safety net: timelocks

There's one more thing to handle: what if the other side simply does nothing — locks up, gets cold feet, or disappears halfway through? You don't want your coins stuck in a locked box forever.

That's what the *timelock* is for. Every locked box has a **built-in deadline**. If the swap hasn't completed by then, the lock releases your funds **back to you**. You get a full refund, automatically, with no cooperation needed from the other side.

Tip — This is why Satchel asks you to pick a **safety timelock** (Short, Medium, or Long) when you post or take an offer. It's choosing how long to wait before that refund deadline kicks in. **Medium** is a sensible default. Longer gives a slow swap more breathing room; shorter gets your money back sooner if something stalls.

The two halves of a swap have slightly different deadlines on purpose — the engine arranges them so that the person who could be left exposed always has time to react or refund. You don't have to think about this; Satchel sets it up correctly and watches the clock for you. (The one thing it needs from you is to **stay running** until the swap finishes — see the chapter "*Backup, Seeds & Safety*".)

So the worst realistic case isn't "I lose my coins." It's "the trade didn't happen, and after the timelock I got my coins back." That's the confidence atomic swaps are designed to give you.

16.4 Two flavours of swap

Satchel knows two ways to build a swap. The cryptography differs under the hood, but what matters to *you* comes down to privacy and how the trade looks on the blockchain. You usually don't pick — Satchel chooses the best method a given trading pair supports — but you'll see them labelled on offers.

16.4.1 Standard (HTLC)

The classic, well-proven method, labelled **Standard (HTLC)** on offers. It uses a special kind of locked output that anyone inspecting the blockchain can recognise as a swap. It's robust, battle-tested, and the default for the first pair, BTCX ↔ BTC.

16.4.2 Private (Taproot)

A newer method, labelled **Private (Taproot)**. When everything goes smoothly, a swap built this way looks like an ordinary, everyday transaction on the blockchain — there’s no obvious “this was a swap” fingerprint for outside observers to see. It uses a more modern Bitcoin feature called Taproot to achieve this.

Note — Both methods are equally *atomic* — equally all-or-nothing, equally protected by timelocks. The difference is privacy and on-chain footprint, not safety. Where a pair supports both, the offer form lets you choose; where it supports only one, Satchel picks it for you.

16.5 Want the real cryptography?

This chapter is the comfortable, plain-language version. If you want to know exactly how the secret is constructed, how the locking scripts are written, how the Taproot signatures combine, and how the timelocks are computed down to the second, that all lives in the **Pact Developer & Integrator Handbook**. It’s written for developers, but it’s there if curiosity strikes.

Note — One honest caveat: Satchel is *alpha* software under external security review. Both swap methods run on mainnet today, but the audit is still ongoing. Trade with funds you’re prepared to put at risk while the software matures — and lean on the safety habits in “*Backup, Seeds & Safety*”.

Chapter 17

Troubleshooting

Things occasionally don't go to plan — a node is down, an address has a typo, a swap seems stuck. This chapter walks through the situations you're most likely to meet and how to put them right. Work top to bottom; each entry is independent, so jump to the one that matches what you're seeing.

Tip — The header at the top of the window is your dashboard. The engine-reachability dot, the Nostr relay dot, the per-coin health glyphs, and the live swap count all tell you at a glance what's healthy and what isn't. Hover any of them for a tooltip.

17.1 “Engine not running” or disconnected

If Satchel shows a disconnected state — the engine indicator is red, and screens can't load data — the app can't reach its swap engine. The usual causes:

1. **A node is down.** The engine talks to your cryptocurrency nodes (Bitcoin, BTCX, and so on). If one isn't running, start it and give it a moment to come up.
2. **The wrong RPC credentials.** If a node is running but the engine can't log in to it, the connection details are off. Open **Settings** → **Coins**, edit the coin, and re-check the host, port, and authentication (cookie file path, or username/password). See the chapter “*Setting Up Your Coins*”.
3. **The engine simply needs a restart.** Closing and reopening Satchel relaunches the engine cleanly.

Note — Satchel needs the engine to be reachable before it can show balances, offers, or swaps. Fixing the engine connection usually fixes several symptoms at once.

17.2 A coin shows a connection error

In **Settings** → **Coins**, each coin carries a status pill. **Connection error** (rather than **Connected**) means Satchel reached the engine but the engine can't talk to that particular node.

To fix it:

1. Confirm the node itself is running and has finished starting up.
2. Open the coin's **Edit connection**, check the host, port, and authentication, then press **Validate node**.
3. A green "Genesis matched" verdict means it's good — press **Save**. A rejection means the details point at the wrong node or network; correct them and validate again.

The chapter "*Setting Up Your Coins*" covers the validation flow and what each field means in detail.

17.3 "Fewer than 2 coins connected"

Satchel needs at least **two live coins** before you can trade — after all, a swap is an exchange between two of them. If you see a "X of 2 coins connected" gate, or the app won't let you past setup, one or both of your coins isn't fully connected.

- The progress line tells you how many are live. Pick a coin that isn't connected and complete its setup.
- A coin counts as *live* only when it's both configured **and** showing **Connected**. A coin with a **Connection error** doesn't count — fix it as above.

Once two coins are green, the gate clears and you can continue.

17.4 No offers on the Corkboard

If the **Corkboard** screen is empty, it's usually one of these:

- **No board or relay configured.** If you see "No Corkboard connected," open **Settings** → **Network** and make sure you have at least one Nostr relay or one Corkboard. A fresh install ships with six Nostr relays, so this is rare unless you cleared the list.
- **You're browsing the wrong board.** The board selector at the top switches between your noticeboards. If your counterparty posted on a specific Corkboard, select that board.
- **The wrong pair, or genuinely no offers.** The Corkboard filters to the trading pair you've selected. Try another pair. A message like "{n} more... Settings → Coins" means there are offers for pairs you haven't connected the coins for yet.
- **It's just quiet.** Sometimes nobody's posted recently. Consider posting your own offer — see the chapter on posting offers.

17.5 A relay shows amber or red

The Nostr relay dot in the header turns **amber** when none of your relays are reachable, and the **Settings** → **Network** list can flag individual ones. Usually:

- **A typo in the address.** Relay addresses must start with `wss://`. Re-check the one you added.

- **That relay is temporarily down.** Public relays come and go. If you have several configured (the default has six), the others keep you running — one amber relay isn't a problem. If *all* are amber, check your internet connection.
- Press **Save & reconnect** after any change to retry the connections.

17.6 A swap looks stuck

A swap that seems frozen is usually just *waiting* — for blockchain confirmations, or for the other side to take their step. Swaps are not instant.

1. **Keep Satchel and your nodes running.** This is the single most important thing. The engine needs to be awake to broadcast the next step — including the refund — at the right time.
2. **Let it run its course.** Check the **Swaps** screen; each row shows a plain- language narration of where it is. If the other side has gone quiet, the engine is already watching the *timelock* on your behalf.
3. **Trust the refund.** If the swap can't complete, the timelock guarantees your locked funds come back to you automatically once its deadline passes. You don't need to do anything except keep the app running. See the chapter "*Backup, Seeds & Safety*".

Warning — Do **not** close Satchel to "reset" a stuck swap. The engine has to be running to finish or refund it. If you must shut down, choose **Keep running** on the quit dialog so the engine continues in the background.

17.7 I can't take an offer

If the **Take offer** button is disabled, or a take fails, the offer isn't available to you right now. Common reasons:

- **It's your own offer.** You can't take an offer you posted — you can only **Withdraw** it.
- **A leg is down.** If one of the two coins involved isn't connected, the take is blocked until you fix that coin (**Settings** → **Coins**).
- **It expired.** Offers have a "valid for" window. An expired offer can't be taken; refresh the board and look for a current one.
- **It was already taken or withdrawn.** Someone else may have taken it first, or the maker pulled it. The offer's state chip tells you which.

17.8 Windows SmartScreen warning

The first time you run Satchel on Windows, **SmartScreen** may show a blue "Windows protected your PC" box. This appears for new applications that aren't yet widely recognised by Microsoft — it isn't a sign anything is wrong with the download.

To proceed, click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.

Tip — Only do this for a copy of Satchel you downloaded from the official project repository. If in doubt about where your download came from, stop and verify the source first — see the chapter *“Where to Get Help”* for the official links.

17.9 Still stuck?

If none of the above fixes it, the chapter *“Where to Get Help”* lists the project repository and community channels, and explains how to file a useful bug report — including which logs to attach (and how to be sure they contain **no** seed or passphrase).

Chapter 18

Frequently Asked Questions

Short answers to the questions people ask most. Each one points to a fuller chapter if you want the detail.

18.1 Is there a fee?

No platform fee. Satchel and the project behind it take *nothing* from your trades — there is no commission, no spread, no membership cost. The only cost you pay is the ordinary **mining fee** (also called a network or transaction fee) that every blockchain charges to confirm a transaction. That fee goes to the blockchain’s miners, never to us, and you’d pay it for any on-chain transaction.

18.2 Who holds my coins?

You do — always. At no point does Satchel, a noticeboard, or your trading partner hold your funds. Your coins stay in wallets you control, on nodes you run, secured by keys only you have. During a swap they’re briefly locked into an all-or-nothing arrangement enforced by the blockchain itself — not handed to anyone.

18.3 Do I need to run nodes?

Yes, for now. Satchel works by talking to your own cryptocurrency nodes (your Bitcoin node, your BTCX node, and so on), which is what keeps everything fully in your control. Setting them up is a one-time job covered in the chapter “*Setting Up Your Coins*”.

Note — A future *nodeless* build is planned, which will let Satchel act as a self-contained wallet without you running full nodes. For this alpha, nodes are required.

18.4 Is it safe to close the app?

Not during a swap. While a swap is in progress, keep Satchel and your nodes running — the engine needs to be awake to broadcast each step (including your refund) on time. If you try to quit mid-swap, Satchel warns you and offers **Keep running** in the background; take that. When no swap is active, you can close it freely. See “*Backup, Seeds & Safety*”.

18.5 What if the other side disappears?

You get refunded, automatically. Every swap has a *timelock* — a built-in deadline. If your counterparty walks away and the swap can’t complete, your locked funds become refundable to you once that deadline passes, with no cooperation needed from them. The chapter “*Understanding Atomic Swaps*” explains why this is guaranteed.

18.6 What’s the difference between public and private offers?

A **public offer** is posted to a noticeboard (Nostr or a Corkboard) where anyone can browse and take it — that’s the **Corkboard** screen. A **private offer** is a *slip* you create and hand directly to one person (paste it into a chat, say); it isn’t posted publicly, and only someone holding the slip can take it. Use public offers to find traders; use private offers to trade with a specific friend. Both settle with the same atomic-swap safety.

18.7 Can I trade on mainnet?

Yes. Both swap types — **Standard (HTLC)** and **Private (Taproot)** — run on real mainnet today.

Warning — Satchel is **alpha** software still under external security review. Mainnet trading works, but treat it accordingly: start small and only trade funds you’re prepared to put at risk while the software and its audit mature.

18.8 What coins are supported?

The first supported pair is **BTCX** ↔ **BTC** (BTCX is Bitcoin-PoCX). **Litecoin (LTC)** was the first added third coin. The list grows over time: coins are defined in a plain text file (`coins.toml`) that ships beside the app, so new ones can be added without rebuilding Satchel. **Settings** → **Coins** shows what’s available and which pairs are ready to trade.

18.9 Where are my keys and seed stored?

On your own machine, never in the cloud. Your recovery phrase and private keys are held locally by the engine and, if you chose a passphrase, stored encrypted. Satchel never sends them to any server, noticeboard, or person — and your settings file (`satchel.json`) never contains

them. The chapter *"Backup, Seeds & Safety"* covers this in full, including the two golden rules for your recovery phrase.

18.10 Will anyone from the project ask for my recovery phrase?

Never. No genuine support person and no one from this project will *ever* ask for your recovery phrase. Anyone who does is trying to steal from you. Satchel only asks for it on its own first-run screen — never on a website, chat, or form.

Chapter 19

Glossary

Plain-language definitions of the terms you'll meet in Satchel and in this handbook. Where a term has its own chapter, that's the place to go for more.

Adaptor swap — See *Taproot swap*. The technical name for the **Private (Taproot)** swap method, where the two payments are linked using a hidden adaptor secret.

Atomic swap — A trade between two cryptocurrencies that is all-or-nothing: either both sides receive their coins or neither does, with no middleman holding funds. The blockchain itself enforces it. See "*Understanding Atomic Swaps*".

Base / quote — The two sides of a trading pair. In **BTCX/BTC**, BTCX is the *base* (the thing being priced) and BTC is the *quote* (what it's priced in). The Corkboard uses this convention to lay out bids and asks.

BTCX / PoCX — **BTCX** is the ticker for **Bitcoin-PoCX** (PoCX = Proof-of- Capacity eXtended), the first coin Satchel trades. BTCX ↔ BTC is the first supported pair.

Confirmation — A blockchain's way of recording that a transaction is settled. Each new block adds one confirmation; more confirmations mean the transaction is more firmly final. Swaps wait for a set number of confirmations before proceeding.

Corkboard — A self-hostable *noticeboard* a community can run on its own server. You point Satchel at its web address to post and browse offers there. See "*Trading over Nostr & Corkboard*".

Engine (pactd) — The local program that does the real swap work on your machine: holding your keys for the session, building and watching swaps, and auto-refunding if needed. Satchel's UI drives it; you'll see it called "the engine." Its technical name is `pactd`.

HTLC — *Hash Time-Locked Contract*: the classic, well-proven way to build an atomic swap, labelled **Standard (HTLC)** on offers. Recognisable on the blockchain as a swap.

Maker / taker — The *maker* is the person who posts an offer; the *taker* is the person who accepts it. You can be either, depending on whether you post or take.

Merchant — A trading identity in Satchel: one seed, one set of keys, one data directory. You can have several merchants (separate identities) and switch between them in the Merchant Manager.

Mining fee — The small fee every blockchain charges to confirm a transaction, paid to miners — not to Satchel. The only cost of a swap, beyond the coins themselves.

Node — The software that connects you to a cryptocurrency's network and holds your wallet for that coin (for example, Bitcoin Core for BTC). Satchel talks to the nodes you run. See "*Setting Up Your Coins*".

Nostr — An open, public messaging network of independent servers (*relays*). Satchel's default *noticeboard*, prewired with six relays. No setup needed. See "*Trading over Nostr & Corkboard*".

Noticeboard — A public place where offers are posted and browsed. Satchel supports two kinds: *Nostr* and *Corkboard*. A noticeboard never holds coins or keys and can't match or execute trades.

Offer — A signed statement of a trade you're willing to make: "I'll give X for Y, valid for this long." Public offers go on a noticeboard; private offers become *slips*.

Pair — Two coins that can be traded against each other, for example BTCX/BTC. **Settings** → **Coins** shows which pairs are ready to trade.

Passphrase — An optional password that encrypts the copy of your seed on this computer. It protects against someone using your machine — but it is *not* your recovery phrase and *not* a backup. Forget it and you must restore from your recovery phrase. See "*Backup, Seeds & Safety*".

Recovery phrase (seed / seed phrase) — The list of 12 or 24 words that *is* your wallet. Write it down offline; never share it. It restores all your funds on any machine. The single most important thing to protect. See "*Backup, Seeds & Safety*".

Redeem — Claiming your side of a completed swap — taking the coins you traded for, once the linked payments unlock.

Refund — Getting your own locked funds back when a swap doesn't complete. The *timelock* makes refunds automatic and guaranteed after its deadline.

Relay — One server on the *Nostr* network. Satchel posts to several at once so no single relay can silence you. The header's relay dot shows whether any are reachable.

RPC — *Remote Procedure Call*: the technical channel Satchel's engine uses to talk to your nodes. You'll meet the term only when entering a node's connection details (RPC host, port, credentials) in **Settings** → **Coins**.

Slip — A private, unposted offer in text form (it starts with `pactoffer1:`). You hand it directly to one person — paste it into a chat — and only someone holding it can take it.

Taker — See *Maker / taker*.

Taproot swap — The newer swap method, labelled **Private (Taproot)**. When it completes smoothly it looks like an ordinary transaction on the blockchain, giving better privacy. Also called an *adaptor swap*. See "*Understanding Atomic Swaps*".

Timelock — A built-in deadline on the funds locked in a swap. If the swap doesn't complete by then, your funds become refundable to you automatically. The safety net behind every swap.

You pick a **Short / Medium / Long** preset when trading.

Trustless — Describes a trade where you don't have to trust the other person or any middleman, because the rules are enforced by the blockchain itself. The whole point of atomic swaps.

Chapter 20

Where to Get Help

Stuck on something this handbook didn't cover, or found a bug? Here's where to turn — and one safety reminder that's worth repeating before anything else.

Warning — **No one from this project will ever ask for your recovery phrase**, your passphrase, or your private keys — not in a chat, not in an “support” message, not anywhere. Anyone who asks is trying to steal from you. Genuine help never needs your seed. See *“Backup, Seeds & Safety”*.

20.1 The project repository

The home of Satchel is its public code repository:

github.com/PoC-Consortium/satchel

There you'll find the latest releases and download links, release notes, the issue tracker, and the source code itself. When you want the official build, this is the place to get it — and the only place to trust a download from.

Tip — Satchel can also tell you when a new version exists: check **Settings** → **About**, which shows your version and an update notice when one's available.

20.2 Filing an issue

If something's broken or behaving oddly, a good bug report helps it get fixed fast. Open an issue on the repository's issue tracker, and include:

1. **Your Satchel version** — from **Settings** → **About** (for example, 0.1 alpha).
2. **Which network** you were on (mainnet, testnet, or regtest) and which **coins and pair** were involved.
3. **What you did, what you expected, and what actually happened** — step by step.
4. **Relevant logs**, if you have them — they often pin down the cause quickly.

Warning — Before you paste any log, configuration, or screenshot into a bug report, **double-check it contains no recovery phrase, passphrase, or private key**. Satchel keeps secrets out of its logs by design, but always glance over anything you share. When in doubt, leave it out.

Note — A first quick stop before filing: the chapter “*Troubleshooting*” covers the most common snags — a node that won’t connect, an empty Corkboard, a swap that looks stuck — and often saves you the trip.

20.3 Community channels

Beyond the repository, the project’s community is the place to ask questions, share what you’re building, and get a hand from other users. The repository’s README and release notes link to the current community channels — check there for the up-to-date list, since the venues can change as the project grows.

When you ask for help, the same etiquette applies as for bug reports: describe what you’re seeing clearly, mention your version and network — and never share your seed.

20.4 For developers: the Pact handbook

This book is the *user’s* guide. If you’re a developer or integrator who wants the machinery underneath — how swaps are constructed transaction by transaction, the exact protocol messages, the engine’s RPC interface, key derivation, and the cryptography — that all lives in the companion book:

Pact Developer & Integrator Handbook

It’s dense and precise, written for people comfortable with Bitcoin and code. If you’ve ever wondered *exactly* how the all-or-nothing guarantee is enforced, or you want to build on top of the engine, that’s your reference.

20.5 A final word

Satchel is young, alpha software, and the project is small and moving fast. That means two things: you may hit rough edges — and your reports genuinely help shape what comes next. Thanks for trading carefully, keeping your recovery phrase safe, and helping the project improve.